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**Financial reports and audited financial statements, and
reports of the Board of Auditors: United Nations**

Implementation of the recommendations of the Board of Auditors contained in its report for the year ended 31 December 2023 on the United Nations

Report of the Secretary-General

Summary

The present report provides information in response to the recommendations of the Board of Auditors as contained in its report for the year ended 31 December 2023 on the United Nations ([A/79/5 \(Vol. I\)](#), chap. II). The report is submitted in accordance with paragraph 7 of General Assembly resolution [48/216 B](#), in which the Secretary-General was requested to report to the Assembly, at the same time as the Board submitted its recommendations to the Assembly, on measures taken or to be taken to implement those recommendations.

The present report provides the Administration's comments and information on the status of implementation, the department responsible, the estimated completion date and the priority of each recommendation contained in the current report of the Board. In addition, the present report contains updated information on the status of implementation of the recommendations of the Board for prior periods that were reported by the Board as not having been fully implemented in the annexes to its report, including those relating to the Umoja system, information and communications technology and the capital master plan.

* [A/79/150](#).



I. Introduction

1. In paragraph 7 of its resolution [48/216 B](#), the General Assembly requested the Secretary-General to report to it on the measures that would be taken to implement the recommendations of the Board of Auditors at the same time as the reports of the Board were submitted to the Assembly. Accordingly, the present report is submitted in response to the recommendations of the Board contained in its report for the year ended 31 December 2023 on the United Nations ([A/79/5 \(Vol. I\)](#), chap. II).

2. In the preparation of the present report, account was taken of the provisions of the following documents:

(a) General Assembly resolution [48/216 B](#), in particular its paragraph 8, in which the Assembly requested the Secretary-General to draw attention in his reports to the recommendations of the Board that would require action by the Assembly;

(b) Resolution [52/212 B](#), in particular its paragraphs 3 to 5, and the note by the Secretary-General transmitting the proposals of the Board for improving the implementation of its recommendations approved by the Assembly ([A/52/753](#), annex);

(c) Resolution [78/242 A](#), in particular its paragraph 8, in which the Assembly reiterated its request to the Secretary-General to ensure full implementation of the recommendations of the Board and the related recommendations of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions in a prompt and timely manner, to continue to hold programme managers accountable for the non-implementation of recommendations and to effectively address the root causes of the problems highlighted by the Board; its paragraph 9, in which the Assembly reiterated its request to the Secretary-General to provide in his reports on the implementation of the recommendations of the Board a full explanation for the delays in the implementation of the recommendations of the Board, in particular those recommendations not yet fully implemented that were two or more years old; and its paragraph 10, in which the Assembly also reiterated its request to the Secretary-General to indicate in future reports an expected time frame for the implementation of the recommendations of the Board, as well as the priorities for their implementation and the office holders to be held accountable.

3. With regard to prioritization, it is noted that the Board categorizes the most important recommendations as “main” recommendations, of which the implementation will be given a high priority.

4. The Administration’s comments were provided on all the recommendations, and most of them have been reflected in the Board’s report. In accordance with paragraph 9 of resolution [78/242 A](#), additional information has been provided on all recommendations corresponding to prior financial periods that the Board considered not to have been fully implemented, including those relating to the Umoja system, information and communications technology (ICT) and the capital master plan.

5. Section II below contains the information requested by the General Assembly on the implementation of the recommendations contained in the reports of the Board on the United Nations. Section II.A provides information on the implementation of the recommendations contained in the Board’s report for the year ended 31 December 2023 and section II.B provides information on the implementation of the recommendations contained in the Board’s reports for prior financial periods that the Board considered not to have been fully implemented.

6. Sections III, IV and V provide information on the implementation of the prior periods recommendations that the Board considered not to have been fully implemented relating to the Umoja system, ICT and the capital master plan.

II. United Nations

A. Implementation of the recommendations contained in the report of the Board of Auditors on the United Nations for the year ended 31 December 2023¹

Overview

7. Tables 1 and 2 provide a summary of the status of implementation of recommendations as of August 2024.

8. Table 1 shows the status of the 26 main recommendations of the Board, of which closure of 2 has been requested and 24 are under implementation. Of the 24 main recommendations that are under implementation, 4 are scheduled to be implemented in 2024, 16 in 2025 and 4 in 2026.

Table 1
Status of implementation of main recommendations

(Number of recommendations)

<i>Department responsible</i>	<i>Total</i>	<i>Closure requested</i>	<i>Not accepted</i>	<i>Under implementation</i>	<i>Target date set</i>	<i>No target date</i>
Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance	12	2	–	10	10	–
Department of Operational Support	1	–	–	1	1	–
Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs	2	–	–	2	2	–
Development Coordination Office	2	–	–	2	2	–
Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs	1	–	–	1	1	–
Office of Information and Communications Technology	3	–	–	3	3	–
Multiple departments	5	–	–	5	5	–
Total	26	2	–	24	24	–

9. Table 2 shows the status of all 72 recommendations of the Board, of which closure of 9 has been requested and 63 are under implementation. Of the 63 recommendations that are under implementation, 14 are scheduled to be implemented in 2024, 44 in 2025 and 5 in 2026.

¹ A/79/5 (Vol. I), chap. II.

Table 2
Status of implementation of all recommendations

(Number of recommendations)

<i>Department responsible</i>	<i>Total</i>	<i>Closure requested</i>	<i>Not accepted</i>	<i>Under implementation</i>	<i>Target date set</i>	<i>No target date</i>
Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance	26	2	—	24	24	—
Department of Operational Support	8	2	—	6	6	—
Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs	3	—	—	3	3	—
Department of Safety and Security	1	1	—	—	—	—
Development Coordination Office	5	2	—	3	3	—
Office of Information and Communications Technology	7	—	—	7	7	—
Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs	8	—	—	8	8	—
United Nations Office at Geneva	1	—	—	1	1	—
United Nations Office at Nairobi	1	—	—	1	1	—
Multiple departments	12	2	—	10	10	—
Total	72	9	—	63	63	—

Detailed information on implementation status

10. In paragraph 28 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration reclassify the hedging gains and losses to be shown separately in the statement of financial performance to enhance the disclosure of the hedging programme, and present the fair value gains/losses on revaluation of investments as reserves in net assets.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: First quarter of 2025

11. The Administration is implementing the recommended changes starting with the 2024 financial year, noting that, in providing enhanced disclosure, it will concurrently reduce alignment between the published financial statements and the published performance report.

12. In paragraph 34 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration expedite the audits of implementing partners and financial closure processes of projects to ensure timely refunds and project closure with a view to improving the efficient utilization of funds thereof.

Departments responsible: Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs, Executive Office of the Secretary-General and Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium
Target date: Fourth quarter of 2025

13. The Administration's comments were reflected in paragraph 32 of the Board's report. In addition, the Administration regularly monitors the status of open commitments relating to completed projects and shares weekly status reports with the entities concerned for further action on the outstanding refunds. While continuous efforts are evident in addressing long-standing claims and refunds, it is important to acknowledge that there will always be some level of pending refunds owing to the ongoing cycle of new grants and projects. The Administration will make every effort to ensure that the pending cases are resolved by the fourth quarter of 2025.

14. In paragraph 43 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration collaborate with relevant departments/entities to strengthen the internal control related to advances to staff and expedite the collection of overdue staff advances.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support
Status: Under implementation
Priority: Medium
Target date: First quarter of 2025

15. The Administration has identified a focal point and has started the training of the relevant staff members to monitor outstanding open items for early notification and to initiate recovery. A target date of the first quarter of 2025 has been set to complete a one-time review of all current open items for inactive staff and items open for more than 90 days for active staff. After the initial review of current open items, a monitoring report will be generated every 90 days to capture new items for continuous monitoring.

16. In paragraph 48 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration strengthen the implementation of the timely recovery process of education grant and travel advances and, more specifically, liaise with Headquarters and other entities to discuss the feasibility of automated recovery for all travel advances processes in order to ensure the collection of any due payments and consistency with staff rules and regulations.

Department responsible: United Nations Office at Geneva
Status: Under implementation
Priority: Medium
Target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

17. The Administration is making efforts to identify and implement a solution to ensure the timely recovery of education grants and travel advances that are not automatically recovered in Umoja.

18. In paragraph 60 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration continue to monitor the relevant reserve levels, ensure that the overall 10RCR fund balance is maintained at an appropriate level in accordance with the relevant policies and guidelines, and utilize the fund more efficiently and effectively.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2025

19. The Administration is continuing its review of the reserve levels of the cost-recovery funds, including by requiring amounts to be set aside for staff liabilities and other necessary operational costs.

20. In paragraph 66 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration update the policy guidance to disclose to the various business owners how the investment revenue of the 10RCR fund will be used.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	First quarter of 2025

21. The Administration will update the policy with the disclosure of the investment revenue.

22. In paragraph 75 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration comply with relevant cost-recovery guidelines to charge for only necessary and reasonable costs in the future.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	United Nations Support Mission in Libya (UNSMIL) and Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	First quarter of 2025

23. UNSMIL indicates that the revised service catalogue is intended to establish reasonable rate cards in collaboration with the master data management team at the Office of Programme Planning, Finance and Budget. UNSMIL will obtain the necessary approvals and create an efficient cost plan. The plan is designed to enhance revenue utilization and address the existing nonexpendable surplus resulting from noncompliance with the cost-recovery policy. The Mission aims to achieve compliance with the 2023 cost-recovery policy by the first quarter of 2025, pending approval of its cost plan by the Controller.

24. The Office of Programme Planning, Finance and Budget is committed to collaborating with UNSMIL on its cost-recovery initiatives.

25. In paragraph 81 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration conduct a comprehensive cost analysis of the services provided and comply with relevant cost-recovery guidelines to charge for only necessary and reasonable costs for office rental charges.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2025

26. The Administration continues to take steps to reduce the current 10RCR surplus, including a decrease in the standard rate for 2024 and 2025. Upon the completion of the DC2 building's lease negotiations, the Administration will conduct a comprehensive cost analysis of the rental charges and adjust the standard rate, as necessary.

27. In paragraph 85 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration conduct a comprehensive cost analysis of the services provided to calculate the updated total cost of ownership, and to align the relevant cost recovery with the appropriate and reasonable charges.

Department responsible: Office of Information and Communications Technology

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Second quarter of 2025

28. The Administration notes that the project on the total cost of ownership and the update of cost-recovery rates is in progress.

29. In paragraph 91 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration re-examine the basis of the preparation of the cost plans to minimize the variation between the projected revenue and expenditure and to avoid any unreasonable overcharging of overhead.

Department responsible: United Nations Office at Nairobi

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2025

30. The United Nations Office at Nairobi continues to review the revenue, expenses, liabilities and fund balances to determine the reasonable level of reserves and balances that can ensure that cost-recovery activities are not putting the United Nations Secretariat at financial risk or creating unfunded liabilities for the assessed budgets. The Office has estimated the termination indemnity and obtained the actuarial valuation for future liabilities relating to staff funded from the cost-recovery fund and will discuss with the Office of the Controller on the required provision.

31. In paragraph 98 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review the use of the 10RCR fund for after-service health insurance and other staff-related transactions to determine if they are relevant to 10RCR and cost recovery.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2025

32. The Administration will conduct a review and find a solution to those transactions that are not related to cost recovery.

33. In paragraph 105 of the report, the Board recommended that the Administration guide responsible entities to conduct a comprehensive review of the receivables in the 10RCR fund and actively attempt to collect overdue receivables.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	First quarter of 2025

34. The Administration already actively attempts to collect overdue receivables and will include specific guidance in both its cost-recovery policy document and annual guidance memo to all service providers.

35. In paragraph 116 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration improve the presentation of budget resources under Income section 2 to ensure more transparency of budget information with regard to spendable revenue and expenditure.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	Not applicable

36. The Administration has implemented this recommendation in the context of the proposed programme budget for 2025. It has included in the supplementary information of the budget fascicle for Income section 2 provided to the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions additional information on the total estimated income of the Organization from the rental of premises by entity, including justifications for the spendable resources.

37. In paragraph 127 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration develop a clear policy guide on spendable rental income and specify the purpose, standards and methodology for calculation of the retention of spendable revenue, as well as its usage, scope and oversight.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	Not applicable

38. The Administration provided a template to clients for submission of the information on spendable rental income. The information was compiled and finalized for inclusion in the supplementary information for the Income section 2 budget fascicle. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

39. In paragraph 139 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration update the budget guide to request respective special political missions to conduct a comprehensive analysis of their own communications and information technology equipment demand plan and to align the plan with budget proposal and implementation in the future.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and Office of Information and Communications Technology
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2025

40. The Administration will include additional instructions in the budget guide to request special political missions to conduct a comprehensive analysis of the ICT equipment demand plan and to align the plan with their budget proposal and implementation. This demand plan will need to be reviewed in consultation with the Office of Information and Communications Technology. Special political missions will be required to liaise with the Office of Information and Communications Technology for ICT resource proposals review prior to the submission of their budget proposals to the Office of Programme Planning, Finance and Budget.

41. In paragraph 152 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration continue to reinforce guidance on multi-year project budget proposals, as well as on budget implementation.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Third quarter of 2025

42. The Administration will continue to strengthen guidance to entities on multi-year project budget proposals and the coherent inclusion of such information in budget reports.

43. **In paragraph 153 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration use an appropriate way to disclose the budget implementation for the two projects, including the extended retention of commitments, to increase information transparency.**

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Second quarter of 2025

44. The Administration is assessing the most appropriate modality to implement this recommendation in the context of the preparation of the budgetary documentation for the proposed programme budget for 2026, by the second quarter of 2025, and to ensure increased transparency in cases in which the Administration allows commitments to remain when critical infrastructure projects are delayed or temporally halted.

45. **In paragraph 163 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that overtime is calculated correctly to avoid overpayment and continue to provide adequate justification when requiring respective additional regular budget resources.**

Department responsible: Department of Safety and Security

Status: Closure requested

Priority: Medium

Target date: Not applicable

46. The Administration has taken the steps necessary to rectify the time entries resulting in payroll recoveries for affected staff members. The Department of Safety and Security has implemented quarterly reviews of overtime entries for validation purposes, and staff are reminded regularly to review and verify their monthly time and attendance records. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

47. **In paragraph 170 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration continue to reinforce guidance on multi-year project budget proposals to ensure that all budget information on specific projects is disclosed in a more coherent and consistent way.**

Departments responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia

Status: Closure requested

Priority: Medium

Target date: Not applicable

48. The Administration has reinforced and continued to strengthen guidance to entities on multi-year project budget proposals and the inclusion of such information

in budget reports in a coherent manner. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

49. In paragraph 180 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration formalize the criteria for selecting investment counterparties, in addition to the existing criteria, to enhance transparency and ensure that the decision-making process is well documented.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

50. The Administration is working to formalize an additional minimum criterion of a minimum shareholder equity size for the selection of recommended banks in order to enhance transparency, which will be included in the United Nations Investment Management Guidelines that are formally approved by the Controller.

51. In paragraph 185 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review and update the relevant policy documents to better clarify the credit rating criteria for foreign currency exchange counterparties.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

52. The Administration is working to align the minimum long-term credit rating criteria for forward transaction counterparties with the minimum long-term credit rating criteria for general foreign exchange (spot transactions) counterparties by updating the United Nations foreign currency hedging and budget rate-setting guidelines.

53. In paragraph 192 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration conduct a comprehensive review of the current policy for and management of the reserve for end-of-service liabilities under extrabudgetary resources, including reserve accrual and adjustment methods, to ensure that funding is maintained at a reasonable level.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: First quarter of 2025

54. The Administration contracted a consulting firm to conduct an in-depth analysis and actuarial review of the end-of-service liabilities. Once the review is concluded, the policy documents will be updated accordingly.

55. In paragraph 200 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration expedite the process of formalizing the investment guideline for end-of-service liability reserves (including after-service health insurance) and engage with the asset management entity to better align assets with respective liabilities.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: First quarter of 2025

56. A separate investment guideline for extrabudgetary after-service health insurance reserves has been drafted and an asset management institution has been preliminarily identified. Once the investment guidelines have been approved, procurement steps and contract negotiations will occur, along with the implementation of the necessary information technology system solution.

57. In paragraph 207 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration expedite the completion of the review of the additional considerations deemed necessary to determine and implement the application of updated distribution rates to allocate after-service health insurance expenditure between the regular budget, the budgets for peacekeeping operations and extrabudgetary resources.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

58. The review by the Administration is in progress. Contractual arrangements have been made for actuarial services to provide required input on the long-term sustainability and financing modality for the extrabudgetary share of annual and future after-service health insurance funding, and on the potential impact that the downsizing and closure of peacekeeping missions is projected to have on funding requirements in the short term and the long term.

59. In paragraph 218 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration conduct comprehensive reviews of equipment records to ensure the accuracy of data in Umoja and take proactive measures to avoid the potential waste of assets.

Departments responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance, United Nations Assistance Mission in Afghanistan (UNAMA) and Department of Safety and Security

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Third quarter of 2025

60. The Administration analysed the data on idle equipment in United Nations entities as reported in volume I in order to determine the root causes for idle assets, and it reported its findings to the Board. It is indicated in the findings that, in addition to the justifiable need for maintaining equipment reserves at some entities for operational reasons, a large percentage of equipment has an incorrect status in the Umoja system records. Some equipment items are not properly assigned upon issuance nor are the equipment records updated by entities in a timely manner during and after the disposal process. The Administration will further increase its efforts to request entities to take immediate corrective action, where appropriate, to address the incorrect equipment records.

61. In paragraph 228 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration improve the monitoring of equipment status and the clean-up of data in Umoja to ensure the effectiveness and efficiency of computing devices management.

Departments responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance, Office of Information and Communications Technology, Enterprise Resource Planning Solution Division, United Nations Regional Office for Central Africa, UNAMA and UNSMIL

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Third quarter of 2025

62. In addition to the Administration's comments above relating to the recommendation in paragraph 218 of the Board's report, the Administration will further increase its efforts to request entities to take immediate corrective action, where appropriate, to address the incorrect equipment records. The target date extension requested for implementation is 30 September 2025.

63. In paragraph 232 of its report, the Board recommended that relevant departments/offices enhance user access, guidance materials and monitoring mechanisms to improve the timeliness of intangible asset capitalization to ensure that expenditure is appropriately classified and recorded in Umoja in the future.

Departments responsible: Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs, Department for General Assembly and Conference Management, United Nations Office at Nairobi and Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

64. The Administration's initial comments were reflected in paragraph 233 of the Board's report, and additional comments from relevant entities are provided below.

65. The Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs is actively working with the Finance Division in the Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance on the capitalization of the intangible assets identified by the Board.

The Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs is also working to ensure that internally developed (and off-the-shelf intangible assets) are identified and capitalized in a timely manner. The enhanced user guidance is being developed.

66. In May 2024, the United Nations Office at Nairobi completed the recognition of its Division of Conference Services cost calculator application as an internally generated intangible asset. The Office will implement a more robust internal control of the review of its applications. The Office is also updating the standard operating procedure for its own intangible assets and those of its clients, which are expected to be reissued in the fourth quarter of 2024.

67. The Department for General Assembly and Conference Management notes that it set up all technology projects with a software development component using the cost object in Umoja, and their cost is reported annually. Intangible assets are capitalized in line with International Public Sector Accounting Standards (IPSAS) guidance. The Department will continue to work with the Division of Conference Services in Nairobi to apply the same principle for software development and that capitalization of assets that meet the threshold.

68. In paragraph 239 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration strengthen oversight on utilization of websites/applications to improve their efficiency and effectiveness.

Departments responsible: Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific (ESCAP) and Office of Information and Communications Technology

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2025

69. ESCAP will collaborate with the Office of Information and Communications Technology to conduct an annual assessment of the oversight and management of internally developed applications and websites.

70. In paragraph 245 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration continue to integrate duplicative system functionalities and data into the further development of new systems under the newly signed service-level agreement with the Office of Information and Communications Technology, thereby enhancing management efficiency and quality.

Departments responsible: Office of Administration of Justice, Department of Global Communications and Office of Information and Communications Technology

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

71. The initial part of the implementation of the service-level agreement between the Office of Information and Communications Technology and the Office of Administration of Justice has already started. As part of the initial package, the development of an automated synchronization mechanism between the Court Case Management System and the jurisprudence database (Caselaw portal) is under way.

72. The technical teams of the Office of Information and Communications Technology and the Office of Administration of Justice are collaborating in the building of a programming interface that serves to push and receive data between the two systems. In addition, the current Caselaw portal search engine is being enhanced with the ability to use operators such as “add”, “or”, “not”, “must” and “within”. The initial package, including the above components, is undergoing an extensive quality assurance process to make sure that it meets business requirements.

73. In paragraph 258 of its report, the Board reiterated its previous recommendation that the Administration fully disclose and justify all general temporary assistance positions in the proposed programme budget, especially those exceeding one year in duration, and strengthen the monitoring of long-term general temporary assistance positions.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2025

74. The Administration considers the recommendation to be implemented and had requested its closure during the Board’s final audit visit for the year ended 31 December 2023, following the issuance of the budget guide for the proposed programme budget for 2025 and the finalization of the budget fascicles for 2025. In order to improve the disclosure of information on all general temporary assistance positions of a continuing nature, the Office of Programme Planning, Finance and Budget provided enhanced guidance to entities in the budget guide on the formulation of the proposed programme budget for 2025, issued in January 2024, as well as additional information (on grade, functional title, date of establishment and justification for the continued need of the position) in the supplementary information provided to the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions. The Administration looks forward to re-engaging with the Board during the upcoming interim audit for the financial year 2024 in order to agree on any additional information that may be required for the closure of the recommendation.

75. In paragraph 259 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration remind concerned entities to report long-vacant positions funded by the regular budget in the budget documentation, as required in the budget guide.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	First quarter of 2025

76. The Administration notes that the information provided in the budget fascicles are forecasts, which may not materialize because of various factors, some of which are beyond the Administration’s control. The Administration intends to provide enhanced guidance in the budget guide for the proposed programme budget for 2026

on how to report long-vacant positions funded from the regular budget, notably by supporting entities with data extracts to facilitate their review.

77. In paragraph 271 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration remind entities to review their current practices of using the fixed-term appointment limited modality and reiterate to all entities the need to abide by the recent policy guideline on the fixed-term appointment limited modality.

Departments responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

78. The Administration will be issuing updated guidance on fixed-term appointments-limited following the policy guidelines issued in March 2024. The updated policy guidance will replace the relevant current guidance on fixed-term appointments within United Nations Secretariat entities, including the Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs.

79. In paragraph 274 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure a timely recruitment process for geographical posts and ensure that appointments from unrepresented and underrepresented countries are in line with the relevant targets.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Second quarter of 2026

80. In coordination with relevant stakeholders, the Office of Human Resources, together with the Business Transformation and Accountability Division, will continue to raise the awareness of heads of entities on the need to ensure that appointments from unrepresented and underrepresented Member States are aligned with the relevant targets.

81. In paragraph 278 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review the incumbency of geographical posts temporarily occupied by staff without geographical status and make the necessary system changes.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Second quarter of 2025

82. The Administration will conduct a review and make system changes, as necessary.

83. In paragraph 282 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration map the young professionals programme rostering process to identify the challenges in adhering to the established timeline with a view to expediting the process.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support
Status: Under implementation
Priority: Medium
Target date: First quarter of 2025

84. The Administration is in the process of outlining improvements to the young professionals programme on the basis of challenges identified, in accordance with the request of the General Assembly in paragraph 33 of its resolution 77/278.

85. In paragraph 286 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that the concerned entities prioritize filling P-2 geographical posts by focusing on the ageing vacant posts.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support
Status: Under implementation
Priority: Medium
Target date: First quarter of 2025

86. The Administration will be launching the next young professionals programme placement exercise by the fourth quarter of 2024, following the conclusion of the managed reassignment programme, and will encourage entities to fill as many P-2 geographical posts as their budget allocations will allow.

87. In paragraph 290 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure adherence to the newly established process of prioritizing the placement of candidate from unrepresented or underrepresented Member States.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support
Status: Closure requested
Priority: Medium
Target date: Not applicable

88. The Administration's comments were reflected in paragraph 289 of the Board's report. The Administration further confirms that the referenced practice is now being followed and resulted in the selection of a candidate from an unrepresented country in July 2024. On the basis of the action taken, the Administration requests the closure of this recommendation by the Board.

89. In paragraph 297 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration update the budget guidance to give more clarity on the establishment, use and reporting of voluntary contribution project positions.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: First quarter of 2025

90. The Administration will provide enhanced guidance in the budget guide for the proposed programme budget for 2026 on how the voluntary contribution project positions should be established, used and reported in a context of funding unpredictability.

91. In paragraph 303 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration request the entities to review the use of temporary appointments and reiterates to entities the need to use temporary appointments to meet only short-term needs that are of a temporary nature.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

92. The Administration will be issuing updated guidance on fixed-term appointments-limited following the policy guidelines issued in March 2024. The updated policy guidance will replace all current guidance on fixed-term appointments within the United Nations Secretariat.

93. In paragraph 312 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration revise the organization of the implementation of the 40 category strategies by classifying them as core or bespoke to ensure a manageable and efficient workplan, in line with the available resources, and consider setting appropriate key performance indicators.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Closure requested

Priority: Medium

Target date: Not applicable

94. The Administration has revised the 40 category strategies by classifying them as core and bespoke. Minutes of the meeting at which the revision was approved were made available to the Board. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

95. In paragraph 323 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration develop a strategy to increase the number of potential vendors in the engineering, design and construction category that are interested in working with the United Nations.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Second quarter of 2025

96. The vendor registration and outreach team has initiated discussions with the engineering category teams to develop a strategy to increase the number of potential vendors and seek ways to reach out to those vendors who meet the Organization's requirements in accordance with the demand plan. This will include market research and outreach through Member States, with the goal of identifying new solutions for the design and production of prefabricated accommodation structures. The Administration will also identify upcoming international exhibitions or trade fairs that provide opportunities to learn about engineering innovations and to connect with potential suppliers and industry experts worldwide in order to expand the Organization's network of suppliers, in particular in the areas of prefabricated construction, sustainable building technologies and innovative housing solutions.

97. In paragraph 330 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration take steps to more accurately forecast the estimated value of a contract as an additional element in the effective assessment of the reasonableness of quoted prices during the financial evaluation for the engineering, design and construction category.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2025

98. The Administration continues to make every effort to improve the accuracy of cost estimates. However, it is important to note that providing precise future cost estimates can be challenging, especially for projects in which the design phase has not been initiated. Accurate cost estimates are more achievable once the construction documents are completed, given that this allows for a more accurate assessment. Without the completion of the design phase, cost estimates are based on experience from previous similar projects and not on concrete project elements.

99. In paragraph 338 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that there is a guideline indicating clearly who should take responsibility to follow up, track and report on the referred cases, which should contain guidance on actions to be taken in a timely manner on those cases referred by the United Nations Dispute Tribunal/the United Nations Appeals Tribunal for possible action to enforce accountability.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Second quarter of 2026

100. In consultation with the Office of Administration of Justice, the Office of Legal Affairs, the Office of Internal Oversight Services (OIOS), the Office of Human Resources, the Office of Programme Planning, Finance and Budget and other relevant stakeholders, the Office of the Under-Secretary-General for Management Policy, Strategy and Compliance will coordinate the review of the related end-to-end process, taking into account legal, policy and operational elements, to develop guidelines for the relevant roles and responsibilities and for the tracking of the United Nations Dispute Tribunal and United Nations Appeals Tribunal referrals to the Secretary-General for possible action, to enforce accountability.

101. In paragraph 343 of its report, the Board recommended that, subject to the legal framework, the Administration better track recoveries that were identified in the recommendations of OIOS.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2026

102. In coordination with relevant stakeholders and in close collaboration with OIOS, the Office of Human Resources, together with the Office of Programme Planning, Finance and Budget, will: (a) coordinate the review of the end-to-end process, including mechanisms used to quantify losses; (b) review existing policies and update them, if required; and (c) document updated processes, including a mechanism for tracking possible “recovery”, subject to the applicable legal framework, identified in OIOS recommendations with potential financial implications.

103. In paragraph 349 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration develop clear guidelines to provide more clarity on the criteria adopted to determine, in the context of management evaluation reviews, whether and how managers who have made inappropriate decisions warrant possible actions to enforce accountability.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2025

104. The Administration notes that the review and discussion of the draft standard operating procedures for the Management Advice and Evaluation Section on managerial recommendations are ongoing.

105. In paragraph 354 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration establish guidelines or standard operating procedures for determining the cost-effectiveness of further action to ascertain the amount of losses, and, subject to the applicable legal framework: (a) for recovering financial losses resulting from established misconduct; and (b) for ensuring that financial losses identified by OIOS or other investigative processes are duly recovered to the greatest extent possible.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2026

106. In coordination with relevant stakeholders and in close collaboration with OIOS, the Office of Human Resources, together with the Office of Programme Planning, Finance and Budget, will: (a) coordinate the review of the end-to-end process, including mechanisms used to quantify losses; (b) review existing policies and update them, if required; (c) review legal implications; and (d) develop guidelines and standard operating procedures for action to ascertain the amount of financial losses and recovery in disciplinary cases, subject to the applicable legal framework.

107. In paragraph 359 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review the approach to granting the within-grade increment to ensure that it aligns with delivery of results, creating a culture of accountability in the Organization.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

108. A revised administrative instruction is pending finalization. Once issued, briefings will be held for the relevant managers and staff members, allowing time for questions and for guidance to be finalized.

109. In paragraph 366 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review its existing processes under the current legal framework in cases where the Organization has suffered a financial loss due to possible gross negligence, to enforce accountability, where appropriate.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2026

110. In coordination with relevant stakeholders and in close collaboration with the Office of Legal Affairs and other relevant stakeholders, the Office of Human Resources, together with the Office of Programme Planning, Finance and Budget, will coordinate the review of existing policies and processes, document the end-to-end process (including enforcement of accountability) under the current legal framework, for handling of cases in which the Organization has suffered a financial loss owing to possible gross negligence.

111. In paragraph 370 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration continue efforts to strengthen the accountability framework for delegation of authority by enhancing the analytical approach to identify systemic issues hampering the improvement of entities' performance against targets, and make concrete recommendations to entities involved on how to improve their performance against the key performance indicators.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Second quarter of 2025

112. The Administration is conducting targeted pilot initiatives to support United Nations Secretariat entities in improving performance in selected areas such as the reporting on exceptions to human resources administrative instructions, Umoja roles requiring delegation of authority and compliance with the travel advance purchase policy. The conclusions and results of the initiatives will inform a decision to expand to other entities or new areas of focus.

113. In paragraph 380 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration address the high concentration of geographical representation in the resident coordinator/humanitarian coordinator talent pipeline by attracting and nurturing more personnel from programme countries.

Department responsible: Development Coordination Office

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Third quarter of 2025

114. The call for expressions of interest for the resident coordinator/humanitarian coordinator talent pipeline was not launched in 2024 owing to the Development Coordination Office's funding shortfall. In 2025, the Office intends to continue its efforts to attract and nurture more personnel from programme countries.

115. In paragraph 392 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration engage with the United Nations Sustainable Development Group governance to draw attention to and address the gaps in the implementation of the efficiency gains road map in a timely manner.

Department responsible: Development Coordination Office

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2025

116. The Development Coordination Office has worked with the United Nations Sustainable Development Group on this recommendation, and some progress has been achieved.

117. In paragraph 401 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration work with the United Nations Sustainable Development Group to strengthen the Group's coordination levy operational guidance to ensure the completeness and accuracy of the contributions subject to levy and that adequate information related to the collection of levies and earmarked contributions is obtained from Group member entities.

Department responsible: Development Coordination Office

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2025

118. The Development Coordination Office is working internally to find the most feasible way to work with the United Nations Sustainable Development Group on the implementation of this recommendation.

119. In paragraph 410 of its report, the Board reiterated its recommendation that the Administration closely monitor the ongoing recruitment process of resident coordinators to ensure that the posts of resident coordinator and the key posts at resident coordinator offices are filled in an expeditious manner.

Department responsible: Development Coordination Office

Status: Closure requested

Priority: Medium

Target date: Not applicable

120. The Administration is closely monitoring the recruitment process of resident coordinators to ensure that such posts are filled in an expeditious manner. As of July 2024, the vacancy rate was only 7 per cent, a historic low. In the light of this low vacancy rate, the Administration requests that this recommendation be closed by the Board.

121. In paragraph 411 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration strengthen measures for reducing the early turnover of resident coordinators to ensure the effective performance of the resident coordinator system.

Department responsible: Development Coordination Office

Status: Closure requested

Priority: Medium

Target date: Not applicable

122. The early turnover of resident coordinators has been reduced to nil. In 2024, no resident coordinator left his or her post before the prescribed time frame. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

123. In paragraph 418 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that relevant management at Headquarters review the

donor reports to ensure that the appropriate level of information is shared with donors after the due scrutiny process.

Departments responsible: Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs and Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Yemen

Status: Closure requested

Priority: Medium

Target date: Not applicable

124. The Administration notes that the project mentioned by the Board was closed in 2018. All donor reporting is conducted in accordance with the signed agreements and/or notes verbales. Due diligence is applied to ensure that the appropriate level of information is shared with donors after a thorough review process. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

125. In paragraph 425 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that a standard and consistent approach is followed in reporting Standby Team of Senior Mediation Advisers activities to donors and ensure that there is equal access by all Member States to non-confidential information on Standby Team activities in a publicly accessible format.

Department responsible: Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

126. The Administration reiterates that reporting to Organization E was in accordance with its earmarked donor agreement, which required more detailed information on project activities, and reiterates that it followed a consistent and established standard methodology in discerning the confidentiality of information provided through its donor reporting, consulting closely with the requesting entities and the regional pillar. The Administration will re-engage with the Board on this matter during its next audit visit.

127. In paragraph 430 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review the tripartite agreement and ensure that it clearly identifies the responsibilities of the peace and development advisers, as well as of the managers of the agreement, and that the advisers' reports are submitted in a timely, consistent manner, following a standardized report template.

Department responsible: Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: First quarter of 2025

128. The Administration will revise the tripartite agreement to clarify the responsibilities of peace and development advisers and tripartite managers, including adviser reporting requirements. The tripartite agreement, along with the reporting guidelines, will be systematically shared with the advisers and tripartite managers upon each new deployment. In addition, reminders about reporting requirements will be sent to all advisers and tripartite managers annually. The reporting guidelines will include a suggested reporting structure, which can be tailored to the specific needs of each country.

129. In paragraph 435 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration use appropriate methods and reporting channels, in particular multi-year appeal reports, to provide additional information on Member States' requests for assistance and the nature of any assistance provided.

Department responsible: Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs
Status: Under implementation
Priority: Medium
Target date: Third quarter of 2025

130. The Administration will ensure that the recommendation is implemented by the target date. Steps are being taken to further strengthen the inclusion of the suggested information in the multi-year appeal related reports.

131. In paragraph 447 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration, in alignment with the global guidelines for country-based pooled funds, clearly disclose, for allocations that are not fully competitive, the partner pre-selection criteria.

Department responsible: Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs
Status: Under implementation
Priority: Medium
Target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

132. Guidance has been drafted and is under review for endorsement and dissemination. The guidance will provide information on how to disclose the pre-selection criteria for reserve allocations to complement the global guidelines.

133. In paragraph 448 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration continue to conduct substantive review of the allocation strategies to ensure their quality and alignment with the global guidelines for country-based pooled funds.

Department responsible: Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs
Status: Under implementation
Priority: Medium
Target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

134. The guidance being prepared, as indicated above in the response to the recommendation in paragraph 447 of the Board's report, will also refer to the Administration continuing to conduct substantive reviews of the allocation strategies.

135. In paragraph 453 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration follow the global guidelines for country-based pooled funds on the pre-identification of partners in the reserve allocation only.

Department responsible: Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

136. Guidance has been drafted and is under review for endorsement and dissemination. The guidance will clarify that the partner pre-identification approach will apply only to reserve allocations.

137. In paragraph 461 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration enhance oversight of the management of funds, especially regarding the use of a separate interest-bearing bank account, where available, accounting separately for the project expenditure, inform the third-party auditors of the funds of \$7.83 million and take follow-up action.

Department responsible: Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Second quarter of 2025

138. In addition to the Administration's comments reflected in paragraph 459 of the Board's report, the Administration has indicated that the third-party audits of the projects are expected to take place in the first half of 2025.

139. In paragraph 469 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration continue to verify the eligibility of all project expenditure through third-party audit firms following completion of the projects, especially with regard to the eligibility of the above-mentioned non-project overhead costs, in accordance with the global guidelines for country-based pooled funds.

Department responsible: Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2025

140. The third-party audits of the projects are expected to be completed by the end of 2025.

141. In paragraph 477 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration expand actions to hold accountable partners that do not refund losses due to fraud cases by strengthening arrangements for sharing information with other United Nations agencies about those partners.

Department responsible: Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Second quarter of 2025

142. Opportunities to strengthen information-sharing arrangements with other United Nations agencies are being explored by the Administration.

143. In paragraph 484 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review and update the guidance on the sharing of fraud case-related information to provide clear minimum criteria for identifying recipients to ensure the security of sensitive information of the Organization, while recognizing that discretion may be required in certain cases to include additional recipients.

Department responsible: Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Second quarter of 2025

144. Opportunities to strengthen information-sharing arrangements with donors are being explored by the Administration.

145. In paragraph 492 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration continue to regularly monitor the composition and rotation of Advisory Board members, which should include periodic rotation of members to the extent possible and in view of practical considerations, to ensure that the actual composition is optimized in support of its remit.

Department responsible: Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2025

146. Regular monitoring will continue of the composition and rotation of Advisory Board members. The target of the fourth quarter of 2025 has been set to allow for the next Advisory Board rotation across all the funds.

147. In paragraph 500 of its report, the Board reiterated its previous recommendation that the Administration ensure that all ICT budget proposals are reviewed on the basis of the same standard and method.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Office of Information and Communications Technology
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2025

148. The Office of Information and Communications Technology, in coordination with the Office of Programme Planning, Finance and Budget, is strengthening the guidance to United Nations Secretariat entities on the preparation and submission of ICT budgets so that entities follow common standard and methods that lead to an agile and effective approach for the timely preparation of ICT budgets in support of organizational mandates.

149. In paragraph 501 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that all United Nations Secretariat entities submit ICT projects with a cost of over \$1 million (over a four-year period) to the ICT Steering Committee for approval.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Office of Information and Communications Technology
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2025

150. The Office of Information and Communications Technology will remind all United Nations entities of the steps required for submitting ICT projects with a total cost of more than \$1 million, over a four-year period, to the ICT Steering Committee.

151. In paragraph 507 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that the Office of Information and Communications Technology, in coordination with the Procurement Division and end-user entities, follow up with the contractors to ensure that the discounts due for ICT contracts are collected in full and in a timely manner.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Office of Information and Communications Technology
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2025

152. The Office of Information and Communications Technology is working with the Procurement Division to ensure that the volume discounts for new purchase orders are applied in Umoja directly. The discount amount for contracts is being worked out with vendors and will be reconciled with entities.

153. In paragraph 518 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that the Office of Information and Communications Technology, together with respective entities, updates the cloud strategy in a timely manner to align it with the latest ICT landscape and business

requirements, enhances public cloud resource utilization and implements cost-saving measures, as appropriate.

Department responsible: Office of Information and Communications Technology

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

154. The Office of Information and Communications Technology is in the process of formulating guidance for hosting, which includes cloud computing as one of the many options. The guidance will equip United Nations Secretariat entities with the information required to make effective decisions relating to hosting, including cloud services.

155. In paragraph 525 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that the Office of Information and Communications Technology strengthens its monitoring and reminder mechanisms to guide entities in Microsoft 365 accounts management and reduce any financial losses.

Department responsible: Office of Information and Communications Technology

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Second quarter of 2025

156. The role of the Office of Information and Communications Technology is to ensure that the guidance, services and procedures necessary are in place to address Microsoft 365 use. It has also provided to all entities the ability to monitor their own Microsoft 365 accounts through the Microsoft 365 usage dashboard, thereby supporting United Nation Secretariat entities in this regard. The Office sent a memo dated 9 July 2024 to all entities in which it announced the implementation of the quarterly disabling and deprovisioning of inactive Microsoft 365 accounts, and will also send automatic notifications to ICT focal points to take action in that regard before the quarterly clean-up.

157. In paragraph 531 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration clearly define the scope of ICT security, including key central and local roles and responsibilities in the ICT accountability framework as part of the ICT governance structure, and ensure that they are properly implemented.

Department responsible: Office of Information and Communications Technology

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Second quarter of 2025

158. The Office of Information and Communications Technology is in the process of incorporating the definition of the scope of ICT security, including specific central and local roles and responsibilities, into the ICT accountability framework.

B. Implementation of the recommendations contained in the reports of the Board of Auditors on the United Nations for prior financial periods

Overview

159. In paragraph 9 of its resolution [78/242 A](#), the General Assembly reiterated its request to the Secretary-General to provide in his reports on the implementation of the recommendations of the Board of Auditors a full explanation for the delays in the implementation of the recommendations of the Board, in particular those recommendations not yet fully implemented that were two or more years old.

160. In annex I to its report on the United Nations for the year ended 31 December 2023, the Board provided a summary of the status of implementation, as of December 2023, of its 220 extant recommendations relating to eight prior financial periods up to 31 December 2022. Of those 220 recommendations, 88 (40 per cent) had been fully implemented, 17 (8 per cent) had been overtaken by events and 115 (52 per cent) were under implementation.

161. The overall status of implementation, as of December 2023, of the recommendations contained in the Board's reports on the United Nations for the eight prior financial periods is shown in table 3, reflecting an aggregate implementation rate of 70 per cent and an additional 13 per cent of recommendations closed by the Board or assessed as overtaken by events.

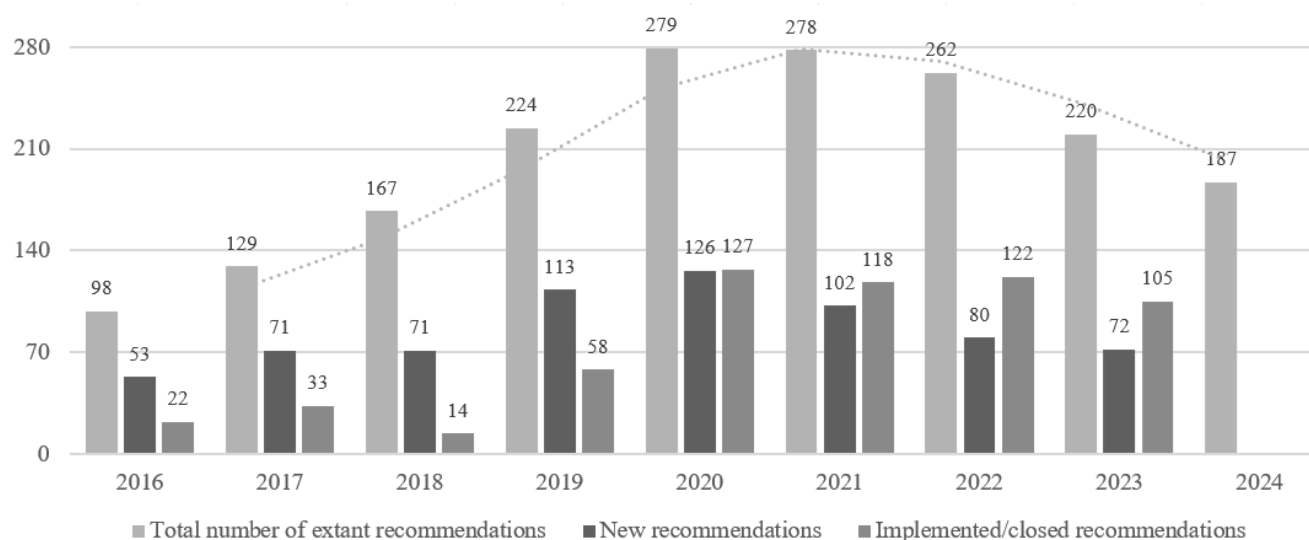
Table 3

Overall status of implementation of the recommendations of the Board of Auditors on the United Nations for eight prior periods, as at 31 December 2023

<i>Period/report No.</i>	<i>Total recommendations issued for each period</i>	<i>Implemented since the issue period</i>	<i>Closed by the Board/ overtaken by events</i>	<i>Under implementation</i>	<i>Not implemented</i>
2015/(A/71/5 (Vol. I) , chap. II)	44	29 (66%)	9 (20%)	6 (14%)	—
2016/(A/72/5 (Vol. I) , chap. II)	53	41 (77%)	12 (23%)	—	—
2017/(A/73/5 (Vol. I) , chap. II)	71	59 (83%)	11 (16%)	1 (1%)	—
2018/(A/74/5 (Vol. I) , chap. II)	71	58 (82%)	9 (13%)	4 (5%)	—
2019/(A/75/5 (Vol. I) , chap. II)	113	89 (79%)	14 (12%)	10 (9%)	—
2020/(A/76/5 (Vol. I) , chap. II)	126	93 (74%)	16 (13%)	17 (13%)	—
2021/(A/77/5 (Vol. I) , chap. II)	102	53 (52%)	10 (10%)	39 (38%)	—
2022/(A/78/5 (Vol. I) , chap. II)	80	40 (50%)	2 (3%)	38 (47%)	—
Total	660	462 (70%)	83 (13%)	115 (17%)	—

162. The figure below shows the overall movement of the extant recommendations of the Board in its reports on the operations of the United Nations as reported in volume I for the financial periods between the 2016 and 2023. Owing to efforts made by the Administration to close recommendations, the number of extant recommendations has been declining over the past four financial periods.

Trends in the implementation of extant recommendations of the Board, 2016–2023



163. Table 4 shows the overall situation, as of August 2024, with respect to the 115 recommendations that had been determined by the Board to be under implementation as of December 2023.

Table 4

Status of implementation of extant recommendations for prior periods considered not fully implemented in annex I to the report of the Board of Auditors on the United Nations for the year ended 31 December 2023

(Number of recommendations)

<i>Department(s) responsible</i>	<i>Total</i>	<i>Closure requested</i>	<i>Not accepted</i>	<i>Under implementation</i>	<i>Target date set</i>	<i>No target date</i>
Department of Economic and Social Affairs	2	—	—	2	2	—
Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance	50	10	—	40	40	—
Department of Operational Support	2	—	—	2	2	—
Development Coordination Office	8	2	—	6	6	—
Economic Commission for Africa	1	—	—	1	1	—
Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs	6	—	—	6	6	—
Office of Information and Communications Technology	22	4	—	18	18	—
United Nations Office at Nairobi	1	—	—	1	1	—
United Nations Office for Partnerships	1	—	—	1	1	—
Multiple departments	22	4	—	18	18	—
Total	115	20	—	95	95	—

164. As indicated in table 4, of the 115 recommendations determined by the Board to be under implementation, closure has been requested for 20 and 95 were under implementation as of August 2024. Of the 95 recommendations that were under implementation, 43 are scheduled to be implemented before the end of 2024, 49 in 2025 and 3 in 2026.

Detailed information on implementation status

Report of the Board for the year ended 31 December 2015²

165. In paragraph 126 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review the completeness of data in the Umoja real estate module and ensure that adequate controls were in place to assure data quality.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and Enterprise Resource Planning Solution Division
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2017
<i>Revised target date:</i>	First quarter of 2025

166. The Administration issued guidance on measurements in August 2023, and the deadline for implementing mandatory changes in the offices away from Headquarters and regional commissions for space, capacity and occupancy measurements was 31 December 2023. As at the end of June 2024, several entities had not completed data entries. The Administration developed and published a status dashboard and is monitoring implementation status and constantly following up on the entry of remaining data. To ensure coordination and consultations with entities, additional time is requested to address other areas of real estate data for completeness and entities' compliance with data quality.

167. In paragraph 135 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration establish standard cost categories for use by each duty station to improve transparency and enable reporting of "cost of the estate per staff member" at each location.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2018
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2025

168. Estates management reporting, analysis and dashboards are internally deployed until the completion of data changes. The development of mapping is ongoing, which will enable cross-functional reporting and analysis. However, it is not possible to proceed with full implementation of these categories owing to the delay in the provision of necessary measurements data.

169. The time frame for completion of establishing standard cost categories is extended to ensure coordination and consultations with entities, address other areas of real estate data for completeness and entities' compliance with data quality, and to

² A/71/5 (Vol. I), chap. II.

accommodate adjustments and changes in analysis and reporting tools, following the transition to Umoja Analytics.

170. In paragraph 141 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration design a common set of performance metrics to help to benchmark performance across each duty station.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2018
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2025

171. The main metrics and additional direct and intermediary metrics have been determined and defined. Elementary metrics are available in internal estate management reports, analysis and dashboards and will be further expanded when the standardized measurements are implemented, along with cost categorizations. The time frame for completion of the implementation of performance metrics and benchmarking has been extended owing to delayed completion of data entries for measurements by entities, to ensure coordination and consultations with entities, to address other areas of real estate data for completeness and entities' compliance with data quality, and to accommodate adjustments and changes in analysis and reporting tools, following the transition to Umoja Analytics.

172. In paragraph 169 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration develop indicators for the handling of disciplinary cases. These indicators should cover: (a) the proportion of referrals that led to a case being initiated; (b) the length of time between referral and case initiation; (c) overall case durations; and (d) case outcomes. The indicators should be used to support improvements in the processes for referring and handling cases.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2019
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2025

173. In addition to the comments reflected in annex I to the Board's report for the year ended 31 December 2023, the Administration would like to note that the average case disposal time improved from 15 months in 2023 to 12.5 months for the first 7 months of 2024. However, the disposal time will increase when older cases from 2021 are completed.

174. In paragraph 256 of its report, the Board recommended that the legal framework around the granting of funds to partners be formally introduced into the Financial Regulations and Rules of the United Nations.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	First quarter of 2020
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2025

175. The Administration is considering submitting a revised proposal to the General Assembly in 2025.

176. In paragraph 264 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration develop a common principles-based framework for the management of partners that specified the key procedures to be performed by all Secretariat entities. To facilitate the development of the common framework, the Secretariat should conduct an end-to-end review of the project management life cycle, including consultations with key stakeholders and a review of all current practices.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Third quarter of 2017
<i>Revised target date:</i>	First quarter of 2025

177. Key common procedures performed by all United Nations Secretariat entities are embedded in the Umoja grantor module, which is the corporate tool used to manage implementing partners throughout the project life cycle. The functionality of the module includes the issuance of a standard implementing partner agreement and will be further enhanced with additional monitoring features. A draft policy covering the principles of implementing partner management is under internal consultation.

Report of the Board for the year ended 31 December 2017³

178. In paragraph 81 of its report, the Board recommended that the United Nations Treasury formalize the participation of different entities in the main cash pool by way of written agreements with them.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2022
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

³ A/73/5 (Vol. I), chap. II.

179. The Financial Resources Management Service is working with the various stakeholders on this matter. The list of organizations participating in the main cash pool is under review to determine the organizations for which an agreement is required. Once the review is completed, written agreements will be established with the organizations identified.

Report of the Board for the year ended 31 December 2018⁴

180. **In paragraph 132 of its report, the Board further recommended that the Administration review the third-party administrator reporting templates for gaps in data quality and standardization and streamline the data elements in the paid claims files to enable authentication of subscribers and expenditure, help identify red flags and carry out correct and comprehensive classification of claims.**

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2020
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

181. Relevant contract provisions and related third-party administrators' comments are undergoing internal review, with an anticipated completion date of 31 December 2024.

182. **In paragraph 142 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration take steps to make it mandatory that all cases of frauds and suspected frauds be reported, as they come to notice, by all third-party administrators.**

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2019
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

183. Draft requirements relating to the mandatory reporting of fraud and suspected fraud are undergoing internal review and review by relevant third-party administrators, with an anticipated completion date of 31 December 2024.

184. **In paragraph 303 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration upgrade the information technology resources of the Non-Governmental Organizations Branch to ensure the efficient and timely processing of new applications for consultative status from NGOs as well as processing of increasing number of quadrennial reports. The Department of**

⁴ A/74/5 (Vol. I), chap. II.

Economic and Social Affairs should also monitor the initiatives by NGOs that are related to the Sustainable Development Goals.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Economic and Social Affairs
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2021
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2026

185. On the basis of testing undertaken, significant issues were identified in the new system that required further development, and the target implementation date has been revised to the fourth quarter of 2026. Analysis is being conducted to determine the extent of any further work required.

186. In paragraph 576 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration focus efforts on avoiding delays in project implementation, particularly for activities identified as being on the critical path, to avoid risk of cost escalation.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Economic Commission for Africa (ECA)
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

187. The Administration's comments were reflected in annex I to the Board's report for the year ended 31 December 2023. In addition, the Africa Hall project team has established a "handover and commissioning" committee, and a comprehensive roles and responsibilities matrix has been developed and disseminated to end users, maintainers and contractors. The testing and commissioning and training schedules are being finalized for each of the specialized fields (e.g., architectural, mechanical and ICT). Proactive engagement with principal stakeholders is being maintained in anticipation of the inauguration.

Report of the Board for the year ended 31 December 2019⁵

188. In paragraph 61 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration carry out a thorough review of the cost-recovery (10RCR) to ensure its reasonableness.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2020
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

⁵ A/75/5 (Vol. I), chap. II.

189. The Administration included guidance on fund balance utilization and surpluses in its annual guidance issued in November 2023. The Administration is also following up with individual service providers on their surplus balances to bring them in line with the guidance. In addition, the Administration is in the process of finalizing amounts to be retained for staffing liabilities for all service providers with staff in the cost-recovery funds.

190. In paragraph 79 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review the programme support cost framework and related instructions, in consultation with entities, to ensure the transparent and timely availability of information on income and costs and harmonized practices across entities for the preparation of cost plans.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2020
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

191. Consultations were undertaken with key stakeholders in the United Nations Office at Geneva, the United Nations Office at Vienna, the United Nations Office at Nairobi, the United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP), the United Nations Human Settlements Programme (UN-Habitat) and ESCAP. The Administration's second internal draft of the guidelines on the management of programme support costs has undergone initial internal review, and the document was revised and updated on the basis of the suggestions and feedback received. The updated draft has been shared with the relevant stakeholders for consultation and comments.

192. In paragraph 90 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration complete the exercise of aligning Umoja objects of expenditure with budget objects of expenditure within a reasonable time frame.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2024
<i>Revised target date:</i>	First quarter of 2025

193. The Administration is taking the final steps to improve the alignment of budget and actual expenditure concerning consultants and individual contractors and to ensure appropriate alignment for all parties using the same objects of expenditure in Umoja. Except for specific cases in which a budget is consolidated to address specific demands (e.g., the presentation of consolidated resources for training), actual expenditure will be aligned with the budget by the first quarter of 2025.

194. In paragraph 129 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration formulate formal guidelines for the management of funds with

negative cash pool balances and that it implement a mechanism for the periodic review of funds with negative cash pool balances.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2020

Revised target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

195. The Administration conducts a monthly review of cash balances to identify any funds with negative cash balances and informs the relevant managers to take corrective action. Formal guidelines on this matter will be finalized by the end of 2024.

196. In paragraph 142 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration coordinate with other entities participating in health insurance plans to establish effective monitoring mechanisms for the accuracy of membership records and contributions.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Closure requested

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2021

Revised target date: Not applicable

197. The Administration provided the Board with information on this matter during the audit visit and will not perform any more work on this recommendation. On the basis of the analysis carried out by the Task Force on Accounting Standards in prior years, the impact of this observation on the calculation of the liability is insignificant. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

198. In paragraph 204 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration take expeditious action to amend and promulgate the Secretary-General's bulletins to specify and enhance the clarity to the roles and responsibilities of the Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and the Department of Operational Support.

Departments responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Original target date: First quarter of 2021

Revised target date: Second quarter of 2025

199. The issuance of the Secretary-General's bulletins remains under consideration.

200. In paragraph 237 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration explore how to specify and document the resources for which authority is delegated and subdelegated.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2021

Revised target date: Second quarter of 2025

201. The revision of the delegation of authority policy ([ST/SGB/2019/2](#)) is in the finalization stage.

202. In paragraph 366 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration take steps to maintain the dual structure, distinguishing between policy formulation and advisory support through the tiered structure for receiving requests and rendering advice to entities across the Secretariat and ensure the integrity and completeness of the data on advice requests at the Department of Operational Support and the Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance.

Departments responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2022

Revised target date: Second quarter of 2025

203. The issuance of the Secretary-General's bulletins remains under consideration.

204. In paragraph 392 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration make a distinction between operational guidance, to be applied using professional judgment and expertise, and mandatory policies, and issue procurement guidance and policy accordingly.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Second quarter of 2021

Revised target date: Third quarter of 2025

205. The Administration remains committed to implementing this audit recommendation and is continuing its work to ensure that a distinction is made

between mandatory policy and operational guidance and that procurement policy and guidance are promulgated accordingly. Substantial progress continues to be made on issuing an administrative instruction with the goal of bridging the gap between the procurement principles set out in the Financial Regulations and Rules and the operational aspects set out in the Procurement Manual. The new policy, which will be promulgated as an administrative instruction, necessitates broad and extensive consultations and discussion across the Organization.

206. In paragraph 420 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration to put in place a mechanism for monitoring the creation and composition of local property survey boards.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Third quarter of 2021
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2025

207. The administrative instruction relating to the creation and composition of local property survey boards is under review and is expected to be promulgated by the second quarter of 2025.

Report of the Board for the year ended 31 December 2020⁶

208. In paragraph 30 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration enhance the performance of fund utilization under the cost-recovery fund (10RCR) to contribute to improved mandate delivery.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2021
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

209. The Administration included guidance on fund balance utilization and surpluses in its annual guidance issued in November 2023. The Administration is also following up with individual service providers on their surplus balances to bring them in line with the guidance. In addition, the Administration is in the process of finalizing amounts to be retained for staffing liabilities for all service providers with staff in the cost-recovery funds.

210. In paragraph 36 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration coordinate closely with the Umoja Change Board regarding the approval and implementation of improvements in the Business Planning and Consolidation Module to ensure that the interface among the different modules

⁶ A/76/5 (Vol. I), chap. II.

in Umoja is enhanced towards the realization of the fully automated generation of financial reports, so as to ensure efficiency in financial reporting.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and Enterprise Resource Planning Solution Division
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2021
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

211. On the basis of consultations with the relevant entities, the Administration determined there was a need to revise the implementation date of the recommendation owing to competing priorities. The Administration will further assess the feasibility for the full integration of all modules for the automation of reports production, including a cost-benefit analysis.

212. In paragraph 107 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration formalize the procedures for cash management under the “T+3” model, clearly defining responsibilities of cashiers at United Nations Headquarters and local offices, and take action to accelerate the progress of modification of the Umoja cashier business roles and the development of the new payroll process model.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and Enterprise Resource Planning Solution Division
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2022
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

213. The new technical Umoja business roles have been developed and are being tested, pending implementation in the production environment.

214. In paragraph 126 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration select custodians on a more transparent and competitive basis and maintain complete documentation of the decision-making process.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2022
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

215. A solicitation exercise for custodian services is being undertaken by the Office of Programme Planning, Finance and Budget in conjunction with the Procurement Division. The request for expression of interest was issued in July 2024.

216. In paragraph 147 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration, in coordination with the third-party administrators, conduct an assessment on the affordability of the Medical Insurance Plan for locally recruited staff and retirees at designated duty stations, by taking into account the current financial situation of the Plan and the increasing cost of health care globally to ensure the sustainability of the Plan.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Third quarter of 2022
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

217. An assessment of the Medical Insurance Plan premium requirements, structure and affordability for locally recruited staff and retirees is a part of the overall review under way of the Plan's operations and financial elements. Contract arrangements have been made for actuarial services to, among others, assess premium requirements and the sustainability of the Plan.

218. In paragraph 158 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration, in coordination with relevant department or office, analyse the reasons for assets remaining idle, actively use idle assets and retire unusable ones, and take more proactive measures to avoid further obsolescence in the future.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	First quarter of 2022
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Not applicable

219. Please refer to the Administration's comments relating to the recommendation in paragraphs 218 and 228 of the Board's report for the year ended 31 December 2023. In the light of the new recommendations mentioned above being similar to this recommendation, the Administration requests the closure of this recommendation by the Board.

220. In paragraph 297 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration continue to work through the joint coordination committee and the Advisory Board of the United Nations Fund for International Partnerships to urge the United Nations Foundation to contribute more resources directly to the United Nations in support of the Organization's activities.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	United Nations Office for Partnerships
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Third quarter of 2022
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Not applicable

221. The Administration continues to engage the United Nations Foundation in order to address this recommendation.

222. In paragraph 378 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration address deficiencies in the linkages among information systems to better support the monitoring of exceptions in coordination with the enterprise resource planning teams.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance, Enterprise Resource Planning Solution Division and Office of Information and Communications Technology
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2022
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

223. The Administration is waiting for the supplier to provide an estimate of when the exception log feed to SAP HANA will be completed.

224. In paragraph 419 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review the policies on rosters, taking into consideration geographical diversity, gender parity and sunset clauses, to ensure rightsizing based on workforce planning forecasts, clarify accountability for maintaining rosters and formulate guidance for hiring managers on selecting rostered candidates.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and Department of Operational Support
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2022
<i>Revised target date:</i>	First quarter of 2025

225. The revised administrative instruction on staff selection is expected to be issued by the first quarter of 2025.

226. In paragraph 438 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration provide guidance to entities on the proper use of cost-of-living allowance exceptions, taking into consideration the nature of the allowance itself.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Operational Support
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2022
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

227. The Administration continues to guide entities on cost-of-living allowance while the guidance on process is being finalized.

228. In paragraph 493 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration provide support for the work of the Inter-Agency and Expert Group on Sustainable Development Goal Indicators regarding continuous improvement in the Sustainable Development Goal indicator framework.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Economic and Social Affairs
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2025

229. The call for proposals launched in April 2024 generated 68 proposals. After a thorough review, the Inter-Agency and Expert Group on Sustainable Development Goal Indicators selected 15 of those proposals to be included in the global open consultations, held from 15 July to 15 August 2024. The results of those consultations will feed into the Inter-Agency and Expert Group's review of the draft proposal of indicator changes to be included in the 2025 comprehensive review, which will be considered by the Statistical Commission in the first quarter of 2025.

230. In paragraph 509 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration intensify its resource mobilization efforts to ensure adequate, predictable and sustainable funding to support the resident coordinator system.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Development Coordination Office
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2021
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2025

231. The Development Coordination Office remains committed to continuing full-fledged outreach efforts to mobilize voluntary contributions from Member States and to facilitate the timely receipt of United Nations Sustainable Development Group cost-sharing contributions and the coordination levy. All donors who made indications of contributions for 2024 have followed through with their commitments, with additional donors coming on board, including with multi-annual commitments. The Office continues its daily proactive follow-up with donors and Member States to advocate for voluntary contributions, while the consideration by the General Assembly

of the Secretary-General's proposal to find a stable and predictable funding solution for the resident coordinator system is ongoing.

232. In paragraph 516 of its report, the Board reiterated its recommendation that the Administration expand the donor base to encourage contributions, on a voluntary basis, to the capitalization of the Joint Sustainable Development Goals Fund at the required levels.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Development Coordination Office
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2022
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Not applicable

233. As of August 2024, the Joint Sustainable Development Goals Fund had already seen a 10 per cent increase in resource mobilization, receiving \$61.5 million in commitments in 2024, compared with \$55.9 million overall in 2023. This indicates continued support for the Fund's new strategy, which is focused on propelling key Goal transitions. The capitalization of the Fund is also featured prominently in the new funding compact as the United Nations premier innovative funding mechanism to accelerate the achievement of the Goals. Cognizant that the Fund requires continued and scaled-up support from Member States and other donors to reach its required level of capitalization to promote transformative change for Goal transitions by 2030, the Administration requests the closure of this recommendation, given that efforts to expand the donor base have already resulted in an increase in donor commitments.

234. In paragraph 521 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration closely monitor the ongoing recruitment process of resident coordinators to ensure that the posts of resident coordinator and the key posts at resident coordinator offices are filled in an expeditious manner.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Development Coordination Office
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2021
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Not applicable

235. The Development Coordination Office is continuing to closely monitor the ongoing recruitment processes of resident coordinators to ensure that they are recruited in an expeditious manner. As at 1 August 2024, 118 resident coordinator positions were encumbered (91 per cent), 1 remained vacant and 11 were covered by a resident coordinator ad interim (8 per cent), the lowest since the development reform. Four new resident coordinators are expected to deploy imminently, and four positions are pending government clearance. The recruitment for the remaining positions will be launched imminently. In the light of the above developments, the Administration considers this recommendation to be substantively implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

236. In paragraph 684 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration make continuous efforts to trace the refunds outstanding of

country-based pooled fund projects that were already paid by implementing partners and coordinate with the Finance Division to record them in Umoja in a timely manner.

Departments responsible: Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs and Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2023

Revised target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

237. Continuous efforts are reflected in steady progress observed in addressing long-standing claims and refunds, while it is noted that there will always be a certain level of pending refunds owing to the ongoing cycle of new grants and projects.

238. In paragraph 721 of its report, the Board reiterated its recommendation that the Administration clearly define the functions and responsibilities of each division and service within the Office of Information and Communications Technology to avoid duplication and fragmentation within the Office.

Department responsible: Office of Information and Communications Technology

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2022

Revised target date: Second quarter of 2025

239. The Administration has completed the first phase of work to define functions and responsibilities of each division and service within the Office of Information and Communications Technology. A second phase of work to define functions and responsibilities of the Office is under way to update the relevant Secretary-General's bulletins that define the Office's functions. A third phase of work is also under way to comprehensively review and analyse the functions and responsibilities of the Office under the realignment, optimization and integration exercise.

240. In paragraph 731 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration formulate a policy for the ICT support model to support the Organization in continuing to have staff work remotely and safely during and after the COVID-19 pandemic.

Department responsible: Office of Information and Communications Technology

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2022

Revised target date: Second quarter of 2025

241. The use of ICT resources and data policy is being reviewed and will incorporate the use of technology in the context of remote working, especially the use of personal mobile devices. The draft policy is being finalized for issuance.

Report of the Board for the year ended 31 December 2021⁷

242. **In paragraph 45 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration expedite the integration of the meeting management system with Umoja financial system to ensure that cancelled or postponed meetings are incorporated into the revenue adjustment process in accordance with IPSAS requirements.**

Departments responsible: Department for General Assembly and Conference Management and Enterprise Resource Planning Solution Division

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2023

Revised target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

243. The Department for General Assembly and Conference Management has prioritized enhancement of the gMeets system's business readiness for Umoja integration. This has involved implementing key improvements and workflow modifications, including a work-around for the reconciliation of data regarding meetings postponed and cancelled in gMeets with the transactional financial data from Umoja. After Umoja's major upgrade in April 2024, the Department is working closely with the Enterprise Resource Planning Solution Division to evaluate and implement the business requirements for integrating the cost-recovery process with Umoja.

244. **In paragraph 63 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration explore the possibility of establishing a productive and economical cost-tracing regime at the service level to ensure that the full cost of each service category can be measured realistically and objectively, with a view to avoiding any excess recovery or insufficient recovery of costs.**

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2023

Revised target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

245. While the Administration is working on a dashboard that will give more visibility regarding cost-recovery activities, as previously mentioned to the Board, there are practical limitations to establishing a cost-tracing regime.

246. **In paragraph 93 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration formulate additional criteria for future exceptional use of special**

⁷ A/77/5 (Vol. I), chap. II.

commitments and continue to take appropriate action on the remaining balances in line with the provisions of the Financial Regulations and Rules of the United Nations.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2022

Revised target date: Second quarter of 2025

247. The draft criteria are undergoing internal review, with an anticipated completion date of 31 December 2024. The criteria are anticipated to be presented to the General Assembly for its consideration.

248. In paragraph 105 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration fully disclose and justify all general temporary assistance positions in the proposed programme budget, especially those exceeding one year in duration, and strengthen the monitoring of long-term general temporary assistance positions.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Closure requested

Priority: High

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2023

Revised target date: Not applicable

249. The Administration requests that this recommendation by the Board be considered as overtaken by events, given that it was reiterated in paragraph 258 of the Board's report for the year ended 31 December 2023.

250. In paragraph 127 of its report, the Board reiterated that the Administration should continue to review the estimated number of extrabudgetary posts to ensure that the extrabudgetary resource estimates presented in the budget fascicles are as complete and accurate as possible.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Second quarter of 2023

Revised target date: First quarter of 2025

251. The Administration considers the recommendation implemented and had requested its closure on the basis of the continuous improvement of the estimates of extrabudgetary resources, which was acknowledged by the Board during its 2022 audit.

Recalling regulation 1.1, rule 101.1 of the Regulations and Rules Governing Programme Planning, the Programme Aspects of the Budget, the Monitoring of Implementation and the Methods Evaluation, in which it is established that “planning for activities to be partially or fully financed by extrabudgetary funds shall be provisional, and such activities will be implemented only if adequate funds are made available”, the Administration looks forward to re-engaging with the Board during its forthcoming audit visit to define clear and achievable implementation criteria, taking into account the unpredictable nature of extrabudgetary funding.

252. In paragraph 138 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration provide updated guidance to departments and offices to minimize risks to which the United Nations may be exposed when signing and implementing agreements with donors.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Not applicable
<i>Revised target date:</i>	First quarter of 2025

253. The Administration issued guidance and key principles on the acceptance of voluntary contributions in July 2022. The Administration is strengthening the guidelines and will issue an updated consolidated guide that will cover financial and legal aspects.

254. In paragraph 148 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration appropriately deal with the cash pool balances of the three closed country-based pooled fund accounts, properly consolidate the old country-based pooled fund accounts and assign the refunds in a timely manner.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2025

255. Of the three closed country-based pooled funds referred to in the Board’s recommendation, only the closure of one account remains outstanding. The closure process is at an advanced stage and is expected to be completed by the second quarter of 2025.

256. In paragraph 178 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration continue its periodic review of historical purchasing patterns of relevant currencies under the regular budget and extrabudgetary resources and consider expanding the hedging scope for those currencies associated with a high foreign exchange risk.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

257. The review of expenditure by currency and budget source is completed on an annual basis. The analysis to consider expanding the scope is expected to be completed by the end of 2024.

258. In paragraph 191 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration establish formal procedures to review the post-trade date increases in the concentration levels, make decisions on the basis of the nature and risk exposure of investment portfolios, and document the decision-making process appropriately.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2022
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

259. The Administration is in the process of formalizing the documentation of the circumstances and steps to be taken in the unusual situations in which concentration risks increase after trade dates.

260. In paragraph 212 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration expedite the execution of collective negotiations and the formalization of standardized agreements.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2022
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

261. Relevant internal reviews and discussions with the third-party administrators are under way, with anticipated completion by the end of 2024.

262. In paragraph 218 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration develop stand-alone performance evaluation standards and prepare performance reports for health insurance service providers that reflect the Organization's own requests and needs in order to benefit future decision-making processes.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	First quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

263. Relevant internal reviews and discussions with the third-party administrators are under way, with anticipated completion by the end of 2024.

264. In paragraph 226 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration analyse the root causes for those idle assets, update inaccurate equipment records, actively use idle assets and draw up reasonable purchase plans to ensure the improved utilization of resources in the future.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Not applicable
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Not applicable

265. Please refer to the Administration's comments relating to the recommendations in paragraphs 218 and 228 of the Board's report for the year ended 31 December 2023. In the light of the new recommendations mentioned above being similar to this recommendation, the Administration requests the closure of this recommendation by the Board.

266. In paragraph 236 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review the listed records and provide more guidance to relevant departments and offices on asset capitalization to ensure that relevant project expenditure is appropriately classified and recorded in Umoja in the future.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Not applicable

267. The Administration reiterates that IPSAS corporate guidance provides detailed guidance concerning the classification of capitalizable and non-capitalizable expenditure. In addition, project structures are set up to manage the collection of costs and the division of capitalizable and non-capitalizable expenditure. In addition, with regard to the specific expenditure mentioned by the Board, the Administration provided supporting documentation to the Board concerning the expenditure. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

268. In paragraph 243 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration reassess the depreciation and amortization policies and make the adjustments necessary to the useful lives of property, plant and equipment and of intangible assets to ensure the appropriate measurement of assets, in compliance with IPSAS requirements.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Not applicable

269. The useful economic lives were updated in Umoja as at 1 January 2023 and the guidance on useful economic lives by asset class was also updated on the knowledge gateway. In addition, the standard operating procedure for the update of useful economic lives was published on the knowledge gateway in July 2023. Given that the enterprise resource planning system automatically adds the useful life to the asset master record, the Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

270. In paragraph 268 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration develop overarching guidance on the use of general temporary assistance, in which its definition, budgeting, establishment, duration, review and reporting, reclassification and conversion, among others, are stipulated clearly.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Not applicable

271. The Administration reaffirms that updated guidance has been issued to entities in alignment with the budget instructions from the Office of the Controller. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

272. In paragraph 272 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration strengthen monitoring to ensure all the general temporary assistance posts are used in full compliance with the related policies and regulations.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	High

Original target date: Second quarter of 2023

Revised target date: Not applicable

273. Revised guidance has been provided to entities in the context of the budget, as issued by the Controller. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

274. In paragraph 283 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that all positions at the D-1 level and above to be established for a duration of more than one year are sufficiently reviewed and approved by the governing bodies.

Departments responsible: Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs and Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2023

Revised target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

275. With respect to the Deputy Humanitarian Coordinator/Regional Humanitarian Coordinator positions referenced, these were not Secretariat positions but rather United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) positions that fell under the Inter-Agency Standing Committee mechanism. Therefore, while the Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs agrees with the content of the recommendation, it continues to advocate for the exclusion of these positions from the scope of this recommendation, given their specific governance structure.

276. In paragraph 286 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that a clear legal framework is in place for staff between the entities of the United Nations as reported in volume I and UNDP.

Departments responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2023

Revised target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

277. The Secretariat is coordinating with UNDP to address the various elements of the legal framework. As regards the amendments to the letter of appointments, UNDP has already begun to issue the amended letter of offer/appointment to all new hires effective 15 May 2023 for all National Professional Officers and General Service staff in the field administered by UNDP with services limited to Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs. Discussions are ongoing on how these changes will be reflected in letters of appointment issued prior to 15 May 2023. UNDP is working on a proposal and schedule on how to proceed with the implementation of these changes.

278. In paragraph 309 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration conduct a cost-benefit analysis before engaging personnel through the United Nations Office for Project Services (UNOPS), UNDP or third-party service providers and clearly define the identity of personnel to ensure the correct application of the legal framework and contractual responsibilities.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs, Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs and Office of Information and Communications Technology
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	First quarter of 2025

279. The Mediation Support Unit in the Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs commissioned a cost-benefit analysis of its current financial agreements with UNOPS for the standby team project. The study, conducted by an external expert, was finalized in December 2022 and shared with the Board in March 2023. The Board found that the current Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs-UNOPS arrangement was cost-effective, efficient and fit for purpose and compliant with applicable United Nations administrative rules and regulations. The current financial agreements on the standby team project remain effective until the fourth quarter of 2024. Updated financial agreements in line with the provisions of the new UNOPS-United Nations Secretariat memorandum of understanding are expected to come into effect in the first quarter of 2025.

280. The Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs also presented a cost-benefit analysis to the Board in May 2023, which illustrated the efficiency and cost-effectiveness of UNOPS support for the Department's innovation projects. Given that the new UNOPS-United Nations Secretariat memorandum of understanding was released only in May 2024, the new financial agreements are expected to start in the fourth quarter of 2024.

281. The current financial agreements between the Office of Information and Communications Technology and UNOPS are for managed services and in accordance with the framework of the new memorandum of understanding between the United Nations Secretariat and UNOPS. A cost-benefit analysis will be conducted during the first quarter of 2025 to ensure efficiency and cost effectiveness.

282. In paragraph 317 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review the current practice of rehiring consultants under vendor contracts in terms of its compliance with existing guidance, cost-effectiveness and appropriateness.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Office of Information and Communications Technology and Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Not applicable

283. The Office of Information and Communications Technology is following the guidance and will not be requesting transfer of ICT consultants to vendor contracts. Engagement of contractual services from vendors will be done against task orders and on the basis of skills requirements and fit. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

284. In paragraph 329 of its report, the Board further recommended that the Administration update the policy to address deficiencies in roster-based recruitment and clean up the roster data.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2023

Revised target date: First quarter of 2025

285. The revised administrative instruction on staff selection is expected to be issued by the first quarter of 2025.

286. In paragraph 333 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration establish a vetting system across the United Nations system to cover all types of misconduct under the leadership of the High-level Committee on Management and expedite the project of automating the vetting process to allow for a link between the Case Management Tracking System and Inspira through Clear Check.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2023

Revised target date: First quarter of 2025

287. The vetting system project is on track for implementation by the first quarter of 2025.

288. In paragraph 338 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration continue to monitor the performance of heads of entities for achieving key performance indicators on geographical representation, issue guidance to entities and develop more proactive measures to improve geographical representation.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Closure requested

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Not applicable

Revised target date: Not applicable

289. The Administration has continued to monitor entities' performance regarding geographical representation, issued guidance and worked on proactive measures to improve equitable geographical distribution for geographical posts and greater geographical representation for non-geographical posts.

290. In April 2024, a communication from the Assistant Secretary-General for Human Resources was dispatched to all heads of entities sharing each entity's performance data towards the equitable geographical distribution target from 2020 to 2023. In the communication, the urgency of making progress was reiterated, especially in the light of General Assembly resolution 77/278, by which the Assembly expanded the posts subject to the system of desirable ranges to include all posts funded by the regular budget at the Professional and higher categories. This includes special political missions and peacekeeping operations, but excludes language posts.

291. The heads of entities were also reminded of the General Assembly's request to urge senior managers to meet the geographical targets outlined in their compacts. In addition, they were informed of the requirement to report on progress achieved in the report on the composition of the Secretariat during the seventy-ninth session of the Assembly.

292. As part of efforts to improve equitable geographical distribution for geographical posts, the Office of Human Resources continues to conduct targeted talent outreach and purposeful partnerships with Member States and resident coordinators and the United Nations information centres and overhaul the staff selection process, which is more of a long-term measure. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

293. In paragraph 358 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration make the registration and recording of vaccines in Everbridge easier for country teams to overcome the challenges in accounting for all vaccines allocated to them, track the utilization of all deployed vaccines as accurately as possible, and produce a comprehensive report at the conclusion of the United Nations System-wide COVID-19 Vaccination Programme.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Operational Support
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

294. The comprehensive report for making the registration and recording in Everbridge easier for country teams has not been finalized and is expected to be done by the fourth quarter of 2024. Additional time is required for further coordination with all relevant United Nations organizations.

295. In paragraph 426 of its report, the Board reiterated its recommendation that the Administration develop a resident coordinator handbook to provide more guidance to resident coordinators ad interim in delivering the expected results.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Development Coordination Office
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2022

Revised target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

296. The development of the resident coordinator handbook has been delayed owing to the Development Coordination Office's funding shortfall but is in progress.

297. In paragraph 433 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration expedite the promulgation of the permanent performance appraisal system for resident coordinators and ensure that a new mechanism is in place to properly measure the performance of United Nations country teams for delivering the expected results as defined in the United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Framework.

Department responsible: Development Coordination Office

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2023

Revised target date: Second quarter of 2025

298. The Development Coordination Office completed the drafting of the administrative instruction on resident coordinator performance management, and it is awaiting review by relevant stakeholders before being promulgated.

299. In paragraph 519 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration take systematic remedial action on the critical risk findings to mitigate the risks and improve the performance of funds in accordance with the revised operational handbook.

Department responsible: Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2022

Revised target date: First quarter of 2025

300. The country-based pooled funds global guidelines, with updated time frames for conducting project audits and enhanced templates and guidance for financial spot checks, were issued in December 2022. An updated financial spot check template is being drafted. Action is ongoing and results are expected to be gradual. Verifiable implementation of updated guidelines is expected by the first quarter of 2025.

301. In paragraph 531 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration conduct project audits within the time frame prescribed in the operational handbook for country-based pooled funds and carry out the financial spot checks in an effective manner by referring to the previous financial spot check and external audit outputs.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2022
<i>Revised target date:</i>	First quarter of 2025

302. Please refer to the Administration's comments above relating to the recommendation in paragraph 519 of the Board's recommendation in its report for the year ended 31 December 2021.

303. In paragraph 552 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration draw experiences and lessons from Department for General Assembly and Conference Management and Department of Safety and Security collaboration and develop guidance on the establishment of ICT governance bodies at the entity level.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Office of Information and Communications Technology
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

304. The Office of Information and Communications Technology is drafting guidance relating to local governance. The implementation of this recommendation is ongoing.

305. In paragraph 560 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that an independent monitoring and accountability mechanism is in place to enforce ICT governance, policies and standards.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Office of Information and Communications Technology
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2025

306. The Office of Information and Communications Technology's work on the drafting of the ICT accountability framework continues. The drafting and review by the working group is expected to be done by the end of 2024. The ICT Steering Committee has advised on the need for extensive consultation on the draft framework with all relevant stakeholders before a final review is undertaken by the Committee. This recommendation continues to be under implementation.

307. In paragraph 567 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration amend the existing ICT governance structure to integrate

information security, indicating clearly, among others, the ownership of processes, roles and responsibilities of relevant entities and reporting lines.

Department responsible: Office of Information and Communications Technology

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2023

Revised target date: Second quarter of 2025

308. Information security is a priority of the United Nations Secretariat and is reflected as one of two critical ICT enterprise risks. The Office of Information and Communications Technology will align meetings of the Information Security Board with the ICT Steering Committee and will introduce regular briefings on information security for the Committee.

309. In paragraph 568 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that all the stakeholders across the Secretariat commit themselves to the implementation of the seven-point information security action plan in an expeditious manner.

Department responsible: Office of Information and Communications Technology

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

Revised target date: Second quarter of 2025

310. Following a presentation to the ICT Steering Committee on feasible solutions, the Administration has decided to reconsider the matter on the basis of the outcome of an OIOS report on a horizontal audit of cybersecurity in the Secretariat. The report will inform an updated proposed action plan that will be considered by the Committee.

311. In paragraph 569 of its report, the Board further recommended that the Administration enhance centralized technical monitoring of ICT security at the entity level and establish accountability mechanisms to ensure full compliance with the security-related policies and standards.

Department responsible: Office of Information and Communications Technology

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

Revised target date: No change

312. Resources required to maintain and to enhance the levels of technical ICT security monitoring were requested as part of the capital investment plan. While the plan was not approved, the Office of Information and Communications Technology

continues to improve the scope of the security technical monitoring within its capacity and will provide requests for additional resources through appropriate budgetary mechanisms. The recommendation is under implementation.

313. In paragraph 576 of its report, the Board reiterated its recommendation that the Administration establish policies, procedures or mechanisms to clarify the roles and responsibilities in data centre operations, update the disaster recovery technical procedure in a timely manner and improve its emergency response coordination mechanism.

Department responsible: Office of Information and Communications Technology

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2022

Revised target date: Second quarter of 2025

314. The Office of Information and Communications Technology's business continuity plan was updated in December 2023. The disaster recovery plan and disaster recovery technical procedures are being updated, with completion forecasted by the end of June 2025. This delay was due to liquidity issues that necessitated the reprioritization of disaster recovery-related activities to the second quarter of 2025.

315. In paragraph 588 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration provide privacy-enhancing mechanisms in coordination with data stewards to ensure that only those nominated by the relevant entities are authorized to have access to the data under their purview.

Department responsible: Office of Information and Communications Technology

Status: Closure requested

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2022

Revised target date: Not applicable

316. The policy was issued and human resources-related processes on the establishment of the Office of Data Protection and Privacy have started, and the Headquarters Client Support Service of the Department of Operational Support is the service provider. Given that the policy is in place and that the General Assembly has approved the establishment of the Office of Data Protection and Privacy, the Office of Information and Communications Technology requests that the Board close the recommendation.

317. In paragraph 593 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration develop a concept note for implementing global ICT asset management and sourcing and a road map for implementing this initiative, and clearly define the roles and responsibilities of the entities involved.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Office of Information and Communications Technology
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2025

318. The concept note outlining the role of property record custodian for ICT assets recording and management will be drafted in consultation with the relevant stakeholders

319. In paragraph 599 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that ICT assets are properly recorded in Umoja for greater visibility and reliability to ensure improved monitoring and controls.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Office of Information and Communications Technology
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Not applicable

320. The Office of Information and Communications Technology has a complete list of more than 35,000 records from Umoja and continues to update them daily following the relevant guidance on assignment of property. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

321. In paragraph 600 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration develop detailed guidelines for ICT asset and inventory management for Secretariat entities to support their effective and efficient management of ICT assets management and sourcing.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Office of Information and Communications Technology
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2025

322. Please refer to the Administration's comments above relating to the recommendation in paragraph 593 of the Board's report for the year ended 31 December 2021.

323. In paragraph 608 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that the Office of Information and Communications Technology conduct a cost-benefit analysis of the use of the personnel under the

financial agreements with UNOPS and conduct comprehensive workforce planning to identify demands, key resources and potential risks.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Office of Information and Communications Technology
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Not applicable

324. The Office of Information and Communications Technology conducted a review of its current contractual engagements through the financial agreement with UNOPS and oversaw the transition in January 2023 to a services-based model for ICT services and projects with payments against service delivery. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

Report of the Board for the year ended 31 December 2022⁸

325. In paragraph 29 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration make appropriate disclosure on the funds received in its budget documents to ensure transparency.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance, Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs and Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2024
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Not applicable

326. The Administration implemented this recommendation in the 2025 programme plan and budget, which discloses additional information on extrabudgetary resources. For the Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs 2025 programme plan and budget, the Administration has disclosed in a footnote the estimated extrabudgetary resources for the Central Emergency Response Fund, country-based pooled funds and Swiss Agency for Development and Cooperation presented in the proposed programme budget document. For section 3 (including the Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs), the footnote refers to the Peacebuilding Fund. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

327. In paragraph 63 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that the special political missions conduct a comprehensive analysis of the root causes for the significant variances between actual vehicle and computing devices holdings and standard allocations.

⁸ A/78/5 (Vol. I), chap. II.

Departments responsible: Office for Disarmament Affairs, Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Syria, United Nations Office for West Africa and the Sahel, United Nations Assistance Mission in Somalia, UNMSIL, United Nations Integrated Office in Haiti (BINUH), United Nations Integrated Transition Assistance Mission in the Sudan, Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Great Lakes Region and UNAMA

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Second quarter of 2024

Revised target date: Second quarter of 2025

328. Following a comprehensive review, the Office for Disarmament Affairs conducted an accurate inventory of computing devices as identified by the Board. The inventory revealed the following: (a) outdated units, which are now scheduled for decommissioning; (b) units assigned to staff members and non-staff experts of the Security Council resolution 1540 support unit; and (c) a unit designated for a conference room. With the disposal process nearing completion, the support unit will achieve the standard device-to-user ratio.

329. The number of computers at BINUH is maintained at the standard 1:1 ratio, in accordance with the Standard Cost and Ratio Manual. Additional computers are kept as spares and issued to staff on the basis of operational requirements, including running the Autocard software, CarLog system, training purposes, Field Technology Services presentations, radio programming, server maintenance and software monitoring. In 2024, BINUH vehicle holdings exceed the standard allocation by 12 units owing to: (a) the operational need for a pool of duty vehicles for medical, security, information technology and engineering personnel to respond swiftly to emergencies; (b) frequent maintenance and repairs necessitated by poor road conditions and prolonged repair durations at outsourced workshops; and (c) the requirement for driver testing vehicles. In 2025, BINUH is projected to exceed the standard allocation by only four units, reflecting an improvement from the previous period.

330. UNSMIL maintains a fleet of 11 vehicles in eastern Libya to support its operations. This arrangement mitigates security risks and transportation costs associated with moving the fleet from west to east. Given the volatile security situation in Libya, the Mission exercises an exception to deviate from the standard vehicle holding ratio. This deviation is essential to ensure business continuity across all locations in Libya while minimizing security risks to staff and United Nations assets. With respect to computing devices, the Mission has initiated replacements, subject to necessary clearances from the host Government.

331. The Office of the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Great Lakes Region maintains an inventory of computing devices that includes those used by consultants, devices maintained as spares and tablets issued to staff on the basis of operational requirements. The current inventory has decreased compared with the December 2022 actual holding owing to the disposal of 21 devices in 2023. The Office plans to conduct a further review of its inventory and write off additional devices in 2024.

332. In paragraph 64 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration update the vehicle holding ratio and related guidance, as well as the computing device allocation “ratio”, as part of the Standard Cost and Ratio Manual in order to enable the missions to improve the transparency and quality of vehicles and computing devices budget proposals in the future.

Departments responsible: Department of Operational Support and Office of Information and Communications Technology

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Original target date: Second quarter of 2024

Revised target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

333. The Administration has updated the Standard Cost and Ratio Manual with the new vehicle ratio and the updated manual is expected to be completed by the end of 2024.

334. The computing device distribution ratio of ICT assets is determined by each entity on the basis of its operational requirements. Although there is no policy as such, the standard ratio is indicatively 1:1, in accordance with the Standard Cost and Ratio Manual, and additional devices can be issued to staff on the basis of operational requirements by entities, through their annual supply chain plans for demand planning. Whereas the Global Asset Management Policy Service in the Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance develops global policies on the basis of the Financial Regulations and Rules that are applicable to all entities, issues such as the rate of utilization differs at each entity and is context-specific, including conditions on the ground. Consequently, this is an issue that is better left to the operational discretion of each entity, with broad guidance from the Department of Operational Support, in conjunction with the Office of Information and Communications Technology, where applicable.

335. In paragraph 90 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration continue to monitor budget implementation, in particular for those entities with continuous overexpenditure on furniture and equipment, in accordance with the parameters established by the General Assembly.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Original target date: Not applicable

Revised target date: Second quarter of 2025

336. In line with legislative recommendations to follow the presentation of peacekeeping budgets, there is no reporting done using the furniture and equipment class of expenditure for special political missions. Information on budget performance is provided in the peacekeeping budget format. For material differences between the budget appropriation and actual expenditure amounts, a full variance analysis is prepared as part of the financial performance report on the programme budget, which, for 2023, was provided in the annexes for the ICT expenditure incurred

in 2023 by special political missions. More detailed explanations are provided in the supplementary information provided to the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions and the Fifth Committee, which includes justification for additional acquisition of ICT equipment owing to operational needs and after considering the current condition of the existing equipment.

337. The Administration considers the recommendation implemented and had requested its closure on the basis of the enhancement of the supplementary of the 2024 proposed budget for special political missions that included an additional annex providing financial performance for 2022, with variance analysis and justification for any material difference between appropriation and expenditure at the budget class level for each mission. It should also be noted that the special political mission budgets were presented to the legislative bodies in the peacekeeping format (using peacekeeping budget classes), and there was no furniture and equipment class in that format. In addition, the Administration added to the allotment advice to special political missions the relevant reminders, but the Board did not agree to close the recommendation.

338. The Administration looks forward to re-engaging with the Board during its next audit visit to define clear and achievable implementation criteria.

339. In paragraph 101 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration update its policies to emphasize monitoring mobile device services usage for non-official purposes.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Office of Information and Communications Technology
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2024
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2025

340. The policy on mobile devices was presented to the Staff-Management Committee and is undergoing the issuance process. In addition, the technical procedure on mobile devices was aligned during the revision process that was led by the ICT Policy Committee.

341. In paragraph 102 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration inform respective entities to implement the mobile communication services recovery and refund mechanism to ensure non-official mobile communication service costs are recovered and refunded to the regular budget in a timely manner.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Office of Information and Communications Technology
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Not applicable

342. Instructions for personnel to mark personal and official business calls is included in the telephone e-billing application, and a sample was provided to the Board. The instructions contain user and entity approver responsibilities for non-official calls of personnel and the reimbursement mechanism is in place for payroll deductions. Full instructions are available to the user upon logging in to the e-billing portal.

343. Verification of official calls marking by staff is the responsibility of the certifying officer within each entity. The Office of Information and Communications Technology processes the recovery of costs on receipt of the funding information from the entities. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

344. In paragraph 109 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration consider the actual deployment and the revised role of the videoconferencing team when updating the agreements with UNOPS.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Office of Information and Communications Technology
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	First quarter of 2024
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2025

345. The Office of Information and Communications Technology revised its financial agreement with UNOPS and included the following language to reflect the virtual events management service: “UNGSC Virtual Events Management Service support from Brindisi and Valencia to the Secretariat locations and other external clients”. The United Nations Secretariat conducts meetings and events on premises, virtually and in hybrid mode (a mix of virtual and in-person components). The virtual events management team will deliver high-quality virtual and hybrid events by ensuring seamless technical execution, including event support, audiovisual production, live multi-language streaming and platform integration.

346. With scattered technology platforms in use throughout the United Nations and multiple end-user devices (personal and in meeting spaces), the virtual events management team will focus on optimizing efficiency and cost effectiveness by streamlining event production processes to maximize efficiency and minimize costs, and leverage technology and automation to streamline event setup, operation and management. The virtual events management team will explore opportunities to repurpose resources across multiple events and continuously evaluate and optimize the use of resources to ensure cost effectiveness.

347. Updated with the most recent trends, technologies and best practices in virtual and hybrid events, the virtual events management team will continuously evaluate and enhance virtual and hybrid event strategies on the basis of feedback and analytics. Working alongside the Global Engineering and Conferencing Section, the team will advocate for innovation and experimentation to drive continuous improvement and encourage collaboration and knowledge-sharing within the United Nations global conferencing community.

348. The United Nations owns on-premise conferencing and collaboration infrastructure for high-level, high-visibility events spanning four geographical locations, which requires technical infrastructure management and support. The virtual events management team will ensure that this infrastructure is robust and

reliable. The team will also explore new technologies and techniques that can be added or to complement existing infrastructure to improve the quality of virtual and hybrid events and to lower costs.

349. In paragraph 133 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration expedite its cleaning up of the legacy accumulated surplus and attribute unassigned accumulated surplus to accountable offices and departments.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

350. The Administration is in the final stages of the clean-up and expects the process to be finished by the end of 2024.

351. In paragraph 182 of its report, the Board recommended that Administration improve the formulation of resource requirements for multi-year capital construction budgets based on actual project implementation and revised project schedules in order to limit the unspent balances of the projects at the end of each budget period.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance, United Nations Office at Geneva and United Nations Office at Nairobi
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Third quarter of 2025

352. The Administration continues to align the projected resource requirements for the upcoming period with both the most recent project schedule and the revised cost plan, while fully taking into account the projected unused balance at the end of the current period, and only the net requirement is being requested in the annual progress reports of major construction projects.

353. The updated project implementation, project schedules and status of appropriation for the United Nations Office at Nairobi's office blocks A to J project will be presented in the report of the Secretary-General at the seventy-ninth session of the General Assembly, in 2024. The Office remains confident that the project implementation schedules will be on track and within the approved budget.

354. The United Nations Office at Geneva is preparing the Secretary-General's eleventh annual progress report on the strategic heritage plan and is confident that it will show a projected year-end unspent balance that is substantially lower than the previous year's balance. This report will also include an updated project schedule and overall cost plan, reflecting the ongoing efforts to enhance scheduling and cost forecasting.

355. In paragraph 191 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration expedite its review and revision of the administrative instruction on programme support accounts to ensure the effective utilization of the programme support cost funds.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

Revised target date: No change

356. Consultations were undertaken with key stakeholders in the United Nations Office at Geneva, the United Nations Office at Vienna, the United Nations Office at Nairobi, UNEP, UN-Habitat and ESCAP. The Administration's second internal draft of the guidelines on the management of programme support costs has undergone initial internal review, and the document was revised and updated on the basis of the suggestions and feedback received. The updated draft has been shared with the relevant stakeholders for consultation and comments.

357. In paragraph 199 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration clearly define the meaning of each set of limits in the United Nations Investment Management Guidelines to avoid different interpretations, and amend the related Asset and Investment Manager compliance rules accordingly.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2023

Revised target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

358. The United Nations Investment Management Guidelines language will be clarified to facilitate clear interpretation of the rules without any ambiguity. The Bloomberg Asset and Investment Manager rules will also be updated.

359. In paragraph 207 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration clarify the credit rating rules in the investment guidelines to ensure that the actual investment practice is consistent with the rules.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2023

Revised target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

360. The United Nations Investment Management Guidelines are being updated to ensure consistent references to the minimum credit rating criteria.

361. In paragraph 223 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration establish an institutional mechanism for United Nations Medical Insurance Plan management to periodically review the performance of the Plan, propose premium rate adjustments and closely monitor the reserve balance of the Plan to ensure its sustainability.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024
<i>Revised target date:</i>	No change

362. The required overall review of the Medical Insurance Plan is under way. Determining the structure of and establishing an institutional mechanism to, among others, review plan performance is a part of this review and is anticipated to be completed by the end of 2024.

363. In paragraph 229 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration closely monitor the reserve balances of the health insurance plans and take appropriate actions in due course to ensure the reserve remains within a reasonable range.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Not applicable
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

364. The annual review of premium requirements for the 2024/25 plan year based on plan performance and reserve balances was concluded, with premium updates implemented effective from 1 July 2024. Periodic monitoring of reserve balances is a standard and ongoing process. Contract arrangements have been made for actuarial services to, among others, review the reserve requirements from an actuarial standpoint to ensure the long-term sustainability of the health insurance plans.

365. In paragraph 241 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration expedite the reconciliation process of accounts receivable to ensure the visibility of actual outstanding amounts and continue to urge relevant agencies and entities to pay their share of contributions to the health insurance funds in a timely manner.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and United Nations Office at Geneva
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

366. The Administration will continue to send monthly statements to the agencies on their outstanding receivables and strengthen its efforts to encourage agencies and other United Nations entities to pay their dues, including their share of contributions to the health insurance funds, on a timely basis. The Administration will also take measures to expedite the reconciliation process of outstanding health insurance receivables to avoid long-outstanding balances and ensure that payments are received from the agencies.

367. With respect to the outstanding receivable balances from the participating entities for the United Nations Staff Mutual Insurance Society, the Administration has implemented appropriate measures, reaffirming its commitment to preventing long-outstanding balances. Consequently, there are no long-standing receivables and the open receivables balance, as at 30 June 2024, consisted exclusively of recently billed amounts owed by participating agencies for services rendered in 2024.

368. In paragraph 259 of its report, the Board further recommended that the Administration conduct a professional assessment of the warehouse's environment at United Nations Headquarters and take necessary measures to ensure the safe storage of heritage assets.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Office of Information and Communications Technology and Department of Operational Support
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2025
<i>Revised target date:</i>	No change

369. Following discussions with the architect on the requirements for the scope of the recommended assessment, a proposal from the architect has been received. Funding will need to be identified to initiate the assessment activity.

370. In paragraph 293 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration closely monitor the project implementation progress, assess and manage the schedule risk in a timely manner and take remedial measures to speed up construction of the new building.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	United Nations Office at Nairobi
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium

Original target date: Not applicable

Revised target date: First quarter of 2025

371. For the office blocks A to J project, the updated schedule forecasts that the new buildings component will be substantially completed by the first quarter of 2025.

372. In paragraph 330 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration continue to support entities in expediting the process of integrating UNDP-administered staff into the Secretariat in a progressive and seamless manner with due regard to ensuring transparency and fairness of the selection process, in accordance with the Organization's regulatory framework.

Departments responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and Department of Operational Support

Status: Closure requested

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Second quarter of 2024

Revised target date: Not applicable

373. The Department of Operational Support encouraged entities to establish a list of current staff administered by UNDP on behalf of the United Nations Secretariat. As of December 2023, 2,100 of those staff remained in the Department of Safety and Security, the Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs, the United Nations Office of Drugs and Crime, UNEP, UN-Habitat, the Department of Global Communications, the Office of the United Nations High Commissioner for Human Rights and the United Nations Conference on Trade and Development. The Department of Operational Support, in coordination with the Office of Human Resources and the Office of the Controller, developed a process guide for entities to transfer staff from UNDP to the United Nations Secretariat administration through the so called "lift and shift" modality. The process guide included a sample project plan and templates for data gathering and verification and was shared with entities in November 2023. The Administration provided extensive training to all relevant entities and provided them with a process guide, a data conversion manual that explains how to record the relevant data conversion personnel action manually in Umoja and templates for the lift and shift modality. On the basis of the above, the Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

374. In paragraph 339 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration conduct a thorough workforce review of the ICT staffing support service and avoid overreliance on third-party contract personnel.

Department responsible: Office of Information and Communications Technology

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

Revised target date: Second quarter of 2025

375. A workforce review of the ICT staffing support services will be concluded by December 2024 to avoid an overreliance on third-party contract personnel. Several steps have already been taken to assess and streamline operations supported by service providers. As part of the workforce review, the Office of Information and Communications Technology is examining the modalities available for ICT service provision with a view to optimizing quality, cost and service levels.

376. In paragraph 355 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review procurement issues that arose from previous solicitations to ensure lessons learned are incorporated into the new procurement process for the same requirements to ensure that the process is in accordance with United Nations procurement principles.

Department responsible: Office of Information and Communications Technology

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Original target date: Not applicable

Revised target date: Second quarter of 2025

377. Steps have been taken to assess and streamline operations supported by ICT contractual personnel, including making the transition to service contract modalities.

378. In paragraph 364 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review the policy on special post allowance to ensure that it is only applicable to exceptional cases.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Original target date: First quarter of 2024

Revised target date: First quarter of 2025

379. The new administrative instruction on special post allowance is expected to be issued by the first quarter of 2025.

380. In paragraph 371 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that the concerned entity, with the guidance of the Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance, review the classification of those general temporary assistance replacement positions.

Departments responsible: ECA and Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Closure requested

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Not applicable

Revised target date: No change

381. Following a thorough review of the categorization of general temporary assistance replacement positions, which are now reported in a transparent manner, ECA confirms that appropriate mechanisms have been instituted to guarantee ongoing full disclosure. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

382. In paragraph 406 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration pilot, in some underrepresented and unrepresented countries, initiatives to ensure job opportunities are sufficiently publicized to attract more applicants and that more knowledge is shared on channels, pipelines, qualifications, etc., for them to be able to be selected.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Not applicable
<i>Revised target date:</i>	No change

383. The Administration has implemented a number of initiatives to ensure that job opportunities are sufficiently publicized and accessible to all underrepresented and unrepresented groups:

(a) As from May 2024, the Office of Human Resources has a LinkedIn Recruiter licence, and this tool is being used to promote General Job Openings, senior-level positions and hard-to-fill position within the Secretariat to talent from diverse backgrounds;

(b) The Office of Human Resources continues to explore the use of paid social media campaign in order to better target applicants from unrepresented and underrepresented Members States. This will be piloted for the 2024 Young Professionals Programme social media campaign;

(c) The Office of Human Resources is implementing purposeful partnerships with a number of Member States, which will provide a more targeted approach to identifying and attracting sources of talent using channels identified by Member States. Member States have more insights into their labour markets and what works more effectively in terms of promoting job opportunities in the United Nations. Such partnerships would also establish pipelines of talent, which will be ready to compete for future job opportunities when they are published.

384. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

385. In paragraph 431 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration, at the level of the Headquarters Committee on Contracts, issue an annual report based on its reviews, focusing on key areas of improvement and good practices that should be shared widely.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2023

Revised target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

386. The Headquarters Committee on Contracts continues to consult with relevant stakeholders to determine the best format and content of the report, which is expected to be issued by the end of 2024.

387. In paragraph 447 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration strengthen the coordination on vendor sanctions with other agencies, funds and programmes of the United Nations system, with the objective of assessing the feasibility and benefits of establishing, in the medium-term, a joint vendor committee to harmonize procedures and actions taken.

Departments responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

Revised target date: No change

388. The lead agency, the International Labour Organization, is working to consolidate all the input received from the legal representatives of the member entities. Upon completion of the consolidation, the draft will be circulated among member organizations for review.

389. In paragraph 455 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration expedite the review and release of the delegation of authority policy framework and put in place a more agile process to update the delegation of authority policy framework in response to changes to the wider policy framework.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2023

Revised target date: Fourth quarter of 2025

390. The revision to the delegation of authority policy is being finalized. The delegation of authority portal, with its related enhancements, will be launched at the same time as the revised policy is promulgated.

391. In paragraph 458 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration conduct a review of the existing key performance indicators to ensure that only those key performance indicators measuring the impact of decisions are used for monitoring delegation of authority before the shift to Umoja Analytics, and conduct more granular and targeted analysis on the priority results of delegation of authority monitoring.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2025

392. The Administration continues its work in mapping the administrative monitoring framework and the review of the existing key performance indicators.

393. In paragraph 486 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration take measures to ensure adequate liquidity to finance operational requirements in the short-term, including ensuring measures for the timely recovery of outstanding receivables, and formulate a comprehensive scenario analysis which covers short-, medium- and long-term plans to address the potential liquidity challenge.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Development Coordination Office
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2025

394. The Development Coordination Office remains fully engaged in mobilizing resources from the three funding streams – voluntary contributions, United Nations Sustainable Development Group cost sharing and the 1 per cent levy in line with General Assembly resolution [72/279](#) – while looking for more predictable and sustainable funding for the resident coordinator system in future. To ensure adequate liquidity to finance operational requirements, the Office has taken several measures in the short, medium, and long term. Together with senior leadership, it has been strongly advocating with representatives from donor countries to fully fund the system and to do so early in the year to avoid a liquidity crunch and provide financial stability in the short and medium term. As a result, some donors have disbursed their funds in the early quarters of the year. The Office consistently follows up with donors and Development Group entities for voluntary contributions and Development Group cost-sharing contributions to collect receivables as early as possible by the due dates. As a result, overdue receivables from pledged contributions under these two funding streams are not significant by the end of each year. For the 1 per cent levy receivables, the Office sends reminders to all Development Group entities twice a year in accordance with established procedures and follows up with individual entities, as necessary, to expedite their remittances. In addition, the Office reviews and analyses the projected cash inflows and outflows on a monthly basis and allocates funds to all units of the resident coordinator system in line with projected liquidity positions, applying some temporary cost mitigation measures, such as temporary recruitment freezes, the curtailment of travel budgets and the postponement of major procurement, including renovation of premises and the acquisition of high-cost assets. Notwithstanding the measures taken, the persistent shortfall in voluntary contributions continues and has been managed through a combination of prudent financial management and the freezing of recruitment in 2023, scaling back capacities

in critical development areas, including to support for United Nations country teams' joint analysis, planning, programming, advocacy and joint resource mobilization and leveraging development financing to accelerate the advancement of the Sustainable Development Goals. To address this and as part of long-term plans, the Secretariat presented a revised estimates report ([A/78/753](#)) for consideration by the Assembly, wherein it is proposed that funding through voluntary contributions be converted to funding from the regular budget. The report will continue to be reviewed by the Fifth Committee at the main part of the Assembly's seventy-ninth session.

395. In paragraph 496 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure recruitment on as wide a geographical basis as possible of resident coordinators and resident coordinator pool members.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Development Coordination Office
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2025

396. As at 1 August 2024, resident coordinators originated from 59 countries and territories. A total of 55 per cent are from programme countries and 45 per cent from non-programme countries. Efforts continue to be made to ensure that the recruitment of resident coordinators is on as wide a geographical basis as possible.

397. In paragraph 514 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that the accountability structure and coordination mechanism under the United Nations Sustainable Development Group is fully functional with regard to the implementation of the development reform initiatives.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Development Coordination Office
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Not applicable
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Third quarter of 2025

398. The United Nations Sustainable Development Group remains fully operational and continues to support the implementation of development reform initiatives as outlined in the management and accountability framework. A review of the framework will be completed in 2025.

399. In paragraph 522 of its report, the Board further recommended that the Administration reference the shared structure under the relevant subprogramme to better reflect the reform structures, and also reflect the shared structures and their mandates in relevant workplans and associated performance reporting.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs and Department of Peace Operations
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	First quarter of 2025
<i>Revised target date:</i>	No change

400. The Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs initiated the consultations necessary to update the narrative in the programme budget plan and strengthen the reference to the single shared regional political-operational structure but ultimately did not manage to include that update in the programme budget plan for 2025. The Department will ensure that the programme budget plan for 2026 reflects that strengthened reference.

401. In paragraph 563 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that the global guidelines for country-based pooled funds provide guidance on requirements for the disclosure of the specific preselection criteria for partners invited to participate in the reserve allocations.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2024
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

402. Guidance has been drafted and is under review for endorsement and dissemination by the end of 2024. It will provide information on how to disclose the pre-selection criteria for reserve allocations to complement the global guidelines.

403. In paragraph 569 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration clarify the process of selecting supplementary partners outside the initial list of preselected partners for reserve allocations in relevant guidance, including but not limited to requirements to document the process, and duly disclose any changes to the initial list of preselected partners.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2024
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

404. Please refer to the Administration's comments above relating to the recommendation in paragraph 563 of the Board's report for the year ended 31 December 2022.

405. In paragraph 579 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration highlight the potential discrepancies identified to the project auditors, conclude ongoing audit processes for the final verification of project deliverables and the determination of any ineligible expenditures and refunds, and follow up on compliance concerns in line with the established procedures.

Department responsible: Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

Revised target date: No change

406. The Administration will ensure that potential discrepancies identified by the Board are duly communicated to the project auditors in due course, in accordance with the regular auditing process, and that compliance cases are followed up within the established procedures.

407. In paragraph 588 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration clarify the balance between the Office of Information and Communications Technology's central control and the entities' operational freedom in the procurement and management of ICT assets as part of the proposed information and communication technology accountability framework, and that the Office of Information and Communications Technology should also establish standards and assessment methods when designating entities as ICT certified.

Department responsible: Office of Information and Communications Technology

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Original target date: First quarter of 2024

Revised target date: Fourth quarter of 2026

408. Work on the drafting of the ICT accountability framework continues. The drafting and review by the working group is expected to be done by the end of 2024. The ICT Steering Committee has advised on the need for extensive consultation on the draft framework with all relevant stakeholders before a final review is undertaken by the Committee. This recommendation continues to be under implementation.

409. In paragraph 591 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration include a clear definition of the roles and duties of the Chief Information and Technology Officer in the ICT governance framework and accountability framework.

Department responsible: Office of Information and Communications Technology

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Original target date: First quarter of 2024
Revised target date: Fourth quarter of 2026

410. The roles and responsibilities of the Chief Information Technology Officer will be further clarified in the report of the Secretary-General on the ICT strategy implementation road map that will be presented at the seventy-ninth session of the General Assembly and clarified in the ICT accountability framework.

411. In paragraph 596 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review the membership of the ICT governance bodies to ensure sufficient and appropriate representation in the committees and ensure that the ICT governance bodies meet at the required frequency, in accordance with their terms of reference.

Department responsible: Office of Information and Communications Technology
Status: Under implementation
Priority: Medium
Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2023
Revised target date: Second quarter of 2025

412. The membership of the governance bodies is being renewed according to the terms of reference.

413. In paragraph 601 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration define the specific areas of cybersecurity that need to be accountable to a central governance function, and encourage all entities to participate in global cybersecurity initiatives to increase visibility of and strengthen cybersecurity.

Department responsible: Office of Information and Communications Technology
Status: Under implementation
Priority: Medium
Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2024
Revised target date: Second quarter of 2025

414. In addition to the implemented action outlined in the previous update to the Board and in order to further improve the accountability of Secretariat entities in the area of ICT security, the Office of Information and Communications Technology is in the process of incorporating the definition of the scope and ICT security-specific central and local roles and responsibilities in the ICT accountability framework.

III. Status of implementation of recommendations on the Umoja system

415. In annex II to its report on the United Nations for the year ended 31 December 2023, the Board provided a summary of the status of implementation of its 17 extant recommendations on the Umoja system relating to prior financial periods. Of the 17 extant recommendations, 8 (47 per cent) had been implemented, 3 (18 per cent) had been overtaken by events and the other 6 (35 per cent) were under implementation.

416. Table 5 presents a summary of the overall situation, as of August 2024 with respect to the six recommendations that were determined by the Board to be under implementation as of December 2023. Of those outstanding recommendations, closure has been requested for one while three are scheduled to be implemented in 2024, one in 2025 and one in 2026.

Table 5

Status of implementation of recommendations for prior periods on Umoja system considered not to have been fully implemented in annex II to the report of the Board of Auditors on the United Nations for the year ended 31 December 2023

(Number of recommendations)

<i>Department responsible</i>	<i>Total</i>	<i>Closure requested</i>	<i>Not accepted</i>	<i>Under implementation</i>	<i>Target date set</i>	<i>No target date</i>
Enterprise Resource Planning Solution Division	6	1	—	5	5	—
Total	6	1	—	5	5	—

Detailed information on implementation status

Eighth annual progress report of the Board of Auditors on the implementation of the United Nations enterprise resource planning system⁹

417. In paragraph 82 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration automate the execution of the main payment proposal in Umoja and minimize the exceptions for which the execution of an ad hoc payment proposal may be required.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Enterprise Resource Planning Solution Division
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2022
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

418. The Administration has automated the execution of the main payment proposal in Umoja to the extent possible and will provide to the Board, by the end of 2024, with data illustrating that the ad hoc payment scenarios have been reduced.

⁹ See [A/74/153](#).

419. In paragraph 83 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review the master data for banking details to identify and correct cases, where necessary, of multiple vendors associated with the same bank account.

Department responsible: Enterprise Resource Planning Solution Division

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2022

Revised target date: Fourth quarter of 2026

420. The Administration continues to review cases of vendors that share the same bank details. Each case is investigated to determine whether the sharing of bank details is legitimate. If it is not legitimate, the vendor is blocked in Umoja, preventing further transactions. Results of the analysis and action taken are documented. The review process is time-consuming and labour-intensive and, consequently, progress is slow owing to competing priorities and the limited resources available.

Ninth annual progress report of the Board of Auditors on the implementation of the United Nations enterprise resource planning system¹⁰

421. In paragraph 120 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration put in place a strong internal control mechanism to ensure the deprovisioning of user roles in Umoja at the time of separation of staff and appropriate updating of the user roles in Umoja when they leave their functions.

Department responsible: Enterprise Resource Planning Solution Division

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2022

Revised target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

422. The Administration has already implemented an internal control mechanism that ensures the cutting off of user access to the Umoja system upon deactivation of the Unite ID at the time of staff separation. In addition, this internal control mechanism will be further strengthened through the implementation of an Umoja automatic deprovisioning programme by the end of 2024.

Eleventh and final annual progress report of the Board of Auditors on the implementation of the United Nations enterprise resource planning system¹¹

423. In paragraph 109 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration continue to conduct user satisfaction surveys for each Umoja Extension 2 solution to identify areas for improvement and further optimization in order to drive user adoption.

¹⁰ [A/75/159](#).

¹¹ [A/77/135](#).

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Enterprise Resource Planning Solution Division
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2022
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2025

424. The Administration will conduct user satisfaction surveys for the Umoja Extension 2 solutions to identify areas for improvement and further optimization in order to drive user adoption. The most recent survey has been drafted and, owing to competing priorities, is now planned to be sent out by the end of 2025.

425. In paragraph 138 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review and rectify, as required, the inaccurate grant values and/or total billing amounts in grant master data that have been identified, and update job aids with additional guidance to reinforce the process as required.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Enterprise Resource Planning Solution Division
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2022
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2024

426. The Administration has included the inconsistent grant and billing values in the monthly internal dashboard and relevant entities are taking appropriate action to review and rectify them, as required. The remaining updates are expected to be completed by the end of 2024.

427. In paragraph 147 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration finalize the United Nations business intelligence standard operating procedure in a timely manner and consider the certification of data models that are used with a high frequency as a high priority.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Enterprise Resource Planning Solution Division
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2022
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Not applicable

428. The Administration keeps the data models in Umoja Analytics standardized by managing such changes through established governance processes and solutions (i.e., SAP Solution Manager). These are the same governance processes in place that manage and ensure the integrity and standardization of Umoja configurations and enhancements. Requests for changes to data models are submitted by business teams and validated by the Enterprise Resource Planning Solution Division's functional and analytics teams to ensure that requirements are valid and implemented in accordance with the relevant standards. Through configured workflows in the SAP Solution Manager, changes are transported and tested through non-production environments and, when successfully confirmed, are transported to the production environment in

line with agreed-upon schedules. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

IV. Status of implementation of recommendations on information and communications technology

429. In annex III to its report on the United Nations for the year ended 31 December 2023, the Board provided a summary of the status of implementation of its 13 extant recommendations on ICT relating to prior periods. Of the 13 extant recommendations, 8 (61 per cent) had been implemented, 1 (8 per cent) had been overtaken by events and 4 (31 per cent) were under implementation.

430. Table 6 presents a summary of the overall situation, as of August 2024, with respect to the four recommendations that were determined by the Board to be under implementation as of December 2023. Of the four outstanding recommendations, closure has been requested for one, while two are scheduled to be implemented in 2024 and one in 2025.

Table 6

Status of implementation of recommendations for prior periods on ICT considered not to have been fully implemented in annex III to the report of the Board of Auditors on the United Nations for the year ended 31 December 2023

(Number of recommendations)

<i>Department responsible</i>	<i>Total</i>	<i>Closure requested</i>	<i>Not accepted</i>	<i>Under implementation</i>	<i>Target date set</i>	<i>No target date</i>
Office of Information and Communications Technology	4	1	—	3	3	—
Total	4	1	—	3	3	—

Detailed information on implementation status

Report of the Board of Auditors on the handling of information and communications technology affairs in the Secretariat¹²

431. In paragraph 31 of its report, the Administration agreed with the Board's recommendation that, in order to enable greater consistency and transparency with regard to ICT funding and budgets and allow better management of costs and effective prioritization, the Controller require that proposed ICT budgets set out: (a) the cost of running day-to-day services; (b) the cost of licences and maintenance costs for existing systems; (c) costs related to upgrading existing service delivery (e.g. to improve security); and (d) new costs, including strategic requirements.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Office of Information and Communications Technology
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium

¹² A/67/651.

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2022

Revised target date: Not applicable

432. The joint memo dated 20 December 2023 of the Assistant Secretary-General, Chief Information and Communications Technology Officer and the Controller contained instructions for all entities to submit ICT-related budget proposals to be reviewed and technically cleared by the Office of Information and Communications Technology. This is done prior to the submission of the complete budget proposals to the Office of Programme Planning, Finance and Budget in line with the established deadlines. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

433. In paragraph 68 of its report, the Administration agreed with the Board's recommendation that it develop a fit-for-purpose governance framework to oversee the strategic development of ICT across the United Nations. This governance framework should clearly set out roles, accountabilities and responsibilities and ensure that decision-making bodies operate distinctly from consultative and advisory forums.

Department responsible: Office of Information and Communications Technology

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Original target date: Second quarter of 2022

Revised target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

434. The draft framework was presented to the ICT Steering Committee in November 2023. The ICT accountability framework is undergoing further drafting under the working group. The draft framework is expected to be circulated to major stakeholders for review by the end of 2024.

Fourth annual progress report of the Board of Auditors on the implementation of the information and communications technology strategy¹³

435. In paragraph 34 of its report, the Board recommended that the Office map the functions, roles and responsibilities of the divisions, sections and services within the Office, based on the report of the Secretary-General (A/72/492/Add.2), in order to avoid overlapping and duplication of functions.

Department responsible: Office of Information and Communications Technology

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Original target date: First quarter of 2022

Revised target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

¹³ A/75/156.

436. The report on realignment, optimization and integration was completed by an external company. The Office of Information and Communications Technology plans to include its functions in the report on refined elements of the ICT strategy that will be issued by the end of 2024.

437. In paragraph 50 of its report, the Board recommended that the Office develop an accountability framework for ICT and that it monitor its implementation in line with its role as a second line of defence for ICT functions.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Office of Information and Communications Technology
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Original target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2022
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2025

438. The drafting of the ICT accountability framework is ongoing. An update was provided to the ICT Steering Committee at its November 2023 meeting. Consultations continue with stakeholders and the ICT accountability framework working group. Extensive consultations will be required once a final draft is in place.

V. Status of implementation of recommendations on the capital master plan

439. In annex IV to its report on the United Nations for the year ended 31 December 2023, the Board provided a summary of the status of implementation of its one extant recommendation on the capital master plan relating to a prior financial period. The recommendation was assessed by the Board to be under implementation.

440. Table 7 provides a summary of the overall situation, as of August 2024, with respect to the recommendation that was assessed to be under implementation as of December 2023, for which the Administration has requested closure by the Board.

Table 7

Status of implementation of the recommendation for a prior period considered not to have been fully implemented in annex IV to the report of the Board of Auditors on the United Nations for the year ended 31 December 2023

(Number of recommendations)

<i>Department responsible</i>	<i>Total</i>	<i>Closure requested</i>	<i>Under implementation</i>	<i>Target date set</i>	<i>No target date</i>
Department of Operational Support	1	1	—	—	—
Total	1	1	—	—	—

Detailed information on implementation status

Report of the Board for the year ended 31 December 2014¹⁴

441. In paragraph 17 (d) of the summary of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration manage the capital master plan to successful completion by reporting the full amount of any savings arising from contract closure and introducing appropriate governance mechanisms to determine the use that could be made of such savings, including specific consideration of returning savings to Member States.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Closure requested

Priority: High

Original target date: Fourth quarter of 2015

Revised target date: Not applicable

442. Pursuant to the partial award for phase II of the remaining arbitration case, the United Nations total liability for phase II is \$5,661,654.73. The current cash balance of the capital master plan fund is \$4,053,412. Given that the full amount of the remaining capital master plan savings will be required to settle this award, there will be no savings to be returned to Member States. Therefore, the Administration requests the closure of this recommendation by the Board because it has been overtaken by events.

¹⁴ A/70/5 (Vol. V).